

@THESKINNYLAWS PRESENTS

The Skinny Laws *Vault*

120 unusual hacks to get lean & stay
lean — without starving

120

hacks

12

laws

30

day plan

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bonuses

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THE 12 LAWS

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Welcome to the Vault

Let's be honest. You've tried the "just eat less" thing. You've downloaded the app, bought the green powder, and started again on Monday more times than you can count. And yet here we are.

Good news: you're not broken, your metabolism isn't "ruined", and you don't need more willpower. You need better tricks. The people who stay lean without trying aren't saints. They're just running on systems they don't even notice anymore.

This Vault is those systems. 120 of them, split into 12 Laws. No starving, no crash diets, no detox tea nonsense. You don't need all 120. Most people find 5 to 10 that fit their life, and that's enough to change everything.

Tap the menu to jump anywhere. Tick "I tried this" as you go, and your progress saves on this device. Now stop scrolling TikTok for diet tips and start here.

How to use it

1

Take the 60-second quiz

Find your eating type. It tells you which Laws to read first.

2

Pick 3 hacks only

Start small. Three hacks you actually do beat thirty you read about.

3

Do the 30-Day Challenge

One tiny action a day. By day 30 the Laws run on autopilot.

4

Come back when you get stuck

Use search or the tag filters to find the right hack for the problem you have today.

What's your eating type?

Answer 5 quick questions. Pick the answer that sounds most like you. No wrong answers.

1. When do you usually eat more than you meant to?

- ☐ All day, a little at a time
- ☐ After a stressful moment
- ☐ After dinner, on the couch
- ☐ Friday to Sunday

2. What is most often in your hand?

- ☐ A snack I grabbed without thinking
- ☐ Something sweet or crunchy to calm down
- ☐ A bowl of something while I watch TV
- ☐ A drink with friends

3. How does your breakfast usually look?

- ☐ Small or on the go, then I pick all morning
- ☐ Depends on my mood and my day
- ☐ Light or nothing, I'm not hungry in the morning
- ☐ Good on weekdays, huge brunch on weekends

4. Finish the sentence: "I'd be lean if only..."

- ☐ I could stop picking at food
- ☐ life was less stressful
- ☐ I could stop snacking at night
- ☐ weekends didn't exist

5. After you overeat, you usually feel...

- ☐ Confused, I didn't even eat a 'meal'
- ☐ Calmer for a minute, then guilty
- ☐ Annoyed, I was so good all day
- ☐ Like I have to start over on Monday

The Hunger Laws

Because 'I'm just a snacky person' is not a personality.

“Willpower is a weak volume knob. Build meals that turn hunger down for you.”

"I'm just always hungry." Girl, you had a granola bar for breakfast, a smoothie for lunch, and you're shocked you want to eat the whole pantry by 4pm? The math ain't mathing.

You're not gonna like this, but you don't have a hunger problem. You have a meal-building problem. Lean people aren't tougher than you. They're just less hungry, because their meals are built to switch hunger off.

Hunger isn't your enemy. It's a signal, and you can turn it up or down with what you eat, what order you eat it in, and how fast you eat it.

So here's what actually works: 10 ways to turn that volume down. No starving. No 'just ignore it.' Real, filling food until you're properly satisfied. That's the whole point.

In this Law:

The Protein Anchor

Veggies Go First

The Vinegar Shot

The Big Bowl Trick

The 20-Minute Meal

The Hunger Scale

Chew Your Calories

The Fiber Stack

The Flavor Fence

The Real Food Default

#001

Hunger

Quick wins

The Protein Anchor

Your 'always hungry' era ends when breakfast stops being a sad little coffee. Protein first.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

Toast and a latte is not breakfast. It's a hunger appointment for 11am.

Build every meal around a palm-to-hand-sized serving of protein, and put it on the plate first. Aim for roughly 25 to 40 grams per meal. Breakfast matters most, because that is where most people eat almost none.

WHY IT WORKS

Scientists call this 'protein leverage.' Researchers Simpson and Raubenheimer found that many animals, and likely humans, keep eating until they hit a protein target. If your food is low in protein, you keep eating to get there. Protein also takes more energy to digest and keeps you full longer than carbs or fat.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Pick your anchor for each meal: eggs, Greek yogurt, chicken, fish, tofu, cottage cheese, lean beef or lentils.
2. Put the protein on the plate before anything else, then add the rest around it.
3. Swap a toast-only or cereal-only breakfast for eggs plus toast, or Greek yogurt plus fruit.
4. Check lunch and dinner tonight: if you can't point to the protein, add some.

Pro move: Keep 'emergency protein' ready: boiled eggs, yogurt cups or a rotisserie chicken in the fridge.

Veggies Go First

Same food, different order, calmer blood sugar. Yes, the order you eat in matters.

THE CALL-OUT

Inhaling the bread basket first, then wondering why you're starving an hour later? Not the plan.

Eat the vegetables on your plate first, then the protein, and save the bread, rice, pasta or potatoes for last. You don't eat less food. You just change the order.

WHY IT WORKS

A 2015 study from Weill Cornell Medicine found that when people ate vegetables and protein before carbs, their blood sugar after the meal was much lower than when they ate the carbs first. Fiber and protein slow down how fast the carbs hit your blood. Smoother blood sugar often means fewer crashes and fewer 'I need a snack now' moments later.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Look at your plate and split it into three zones: veggies, protein, carbs.
2. Eat most of the veggies first, then the protein.
3. Eat the carbs last and slowly.
4. At restaurants, order a side salad or veggie starter so the 'veggies first' part happens automatically.

Pro move: Can't wait for the carbs? Even 10 minutes between the veggies and the bread helps.

The Vinegar Shot

Pasta night? A splash of vinegar first can soften that blood sugar spike.

THE CALL-OUT

Carbs on an empty stomach, zero backup? Your blood sugar is riding a rollercoaster you bought a ticket for.

Before a meal that is heavy in carbs, have 1 tablespoon of vinegar mixed into a big glass of water, or eat a salad with a vinegar dressing first. Apple cider vinegar or any vinegar works. Never drink it straight.

WHY IT WORKS

Several small studies, including work by Carol Johnston at Arizona State University, found that vinegar with a carb meal can lower the blood sugar rise afterwards. The acetic acid seems to slow down how fast your stomach empties and how fast starch turns into sugar. It is not magic fat-burning. It is just a smoother ride after a big carb meal.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Mix 1 tablespoon of vinegar into a large glass of water.
2. Drink it with a straw just before your meal to protect your teeth.
3. Or start the meal with a salad dressed in oil and vinegar.
4. Rinse your mouth with plain water afterwards.

Pro move: If you have reflux, stomach problems or take diabetes medicine, skip this or ask your doctor first.

The Big Bowl Trick

Want a bigger plate for fewer calories? This loophole is legal, I promise.

THE CALL-OUT

A tiny sad portion that leaves you hungry isn't discipline. It's just a bad plate.

Fill your plate with foods that are heavy with water and fiber, like soup, veggies, berries and salad. They take up lots of room in your stomach but carry few calories. You get a big, satisfying portion without overdoing it.

WHY IT WORKS

Barbara Rolls at Penn State spent years studying 'energy density,' which means calories per bite. Her research found that people tend to eat about the same weight of food each day. So when that food is full of water and fiber, you feel full on fewer calories. Her team also found that starting a meal with a broth-based soup or a big salad helped people eat less at the meal overall.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Add one extra cup of veggies to what you already eat: spinach in eggs, zucchini in pasta sauce, peppers in wraps.
2. Swap half the rice or pasta for cauliflower rice or zucchini noodles.
3. Start dinner with a cup of broth-based soup or a big side salad.
4. Choose fresh fruit over dried fruit. Same sugar, way more volume.

Pro move: Mix 'half and half': half normal pasta, half veggie noodles. You barely notice the difference.

The 20-Minute Meal

Your 'I'm full' text arrives late. Stop finishing the plate before it's delivered.

THE CALL-OUT

You didn't eat dinner, you speed-ran it. Your stomach never even got the memo.

Make every main meal last at least 20 minutes. Set a timer if you have to. Slow eating lets your fullness signal catch up with your fork.

WHY IT WORKS

When food reaches your gut, it releases fullness hormones that tell your brain you have had enough. This takes time, often around 20 minutes. If you finish a plate in 7 minutes, your brain has not got the message yet, so you go back for more. Eat slowly and the message shows up while you are still eating.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Put your fork down between every bite.
2. Chew each bite until it is soft, then swallow before picking the fork back up.
3. Take a sip of water or say something to someone between bites.
4. Set a 20-minute timer and try to still have food on your plate when it rings.

Pro move: Eat with your non-dominant hand or with chopsticks. It slows you down with zero effort.

The Hunger Scale

Rate your hunger 1 to 10 and watch autopilot eating lose its job.

THE CALL-OUT

Eating because it's 3pm and the snacks are there is not hunger. It's scheduling.

Before you eat, rate your hunger from 1 (starving and shaky) to 10 (painfully stuffed). Try to start eating at about a 3 or 4 and stop at about a 6 or 7. That is 'comfortably satisfied,' not stuffed.

WHY IT WORKS

Most overeating happens because we don't check in. We eat because food is there or because the plate is not empty. A simple number makes you notice your body. Waiting until you are a 1 or 2 is also a trap, because being too hungry makes you eat fast and overshoot. So this hack is about eating when you are truly hungry, not waiting until you are starving.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Before each meal today, silently give yourself a number from 1 to 10.
2. Halfway through the meal, pause and rate yourself again.
3. When you hit 6 or 7, stop and wait 10 minutes. You can always have more if you are still hungry.
4. If you often reach 1 or 2 during the day, add a snack with protein. Real hunger deserves food.

Pro move: Write your before and after numbers in your phone notes for 3 days. Patterns show up fast.

Chew Your Calories

That 'healthy' smoothie is a meal you drink in 90 seconds, then forget about.

THE CALL-OUT

Drinking a whole meal through a straw and calling it 'just a smoothie'? Bestie, it's a meal.

Get most of your calories from food you chew, not drinks. Swap juices, sweet coffees and big smoothies for whole food. If you love smoothies, make them thick and eat them from a bowl with a spoon.

WHY IT WORKS

Drinks go down fast and skip a lot of the chewing and stomach stretch that tell your brain you are full. Studies comparing liquid and solid versions of similar calories often find that liquid calories are less filling, so people don't eat less later to make up for them. Chewing gives your body time and signals to register the food.

HOW TO DO IT

1. List every drink you had yesterday that was not water, tea or black coffee.
2. Pick one to swap: orange juice becomes a whole orange, a sweet latte becomes a smaller or unsweetened one.
3. If you keep your smoothie, make it thicker, add Greek yogurt for protein, and eat it with a spoon.
4. Add toppings you have to chew, like berries or a few nuts.

Pro move: Order your coffee 'one size smaller.' You still get your ritual.

#008

Hunger

Bloat

The Fiber Stack

Fiber is the fullness tool nobody posts about. Stack it at every meal.

THE CALL-OUT

Beige plate, zero fiber, hungry again in an hour. Not me pretending that's a mystery.

Add one high-fiber food to every meal. Think beans, lentils, chia seeds, oats, berries, pears, raspberries, broccoli or whole grains. Small add-ons count.

WHY IT WORKS

Fiber slows down digestion, adds bulk and feeds the good bacteria in your gut. It keeps food in your stomach longer, so you stay full longer. Most people eat far less fiber than the recommended amount, so this is an easy win for almost everyone.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Stir 1 tablespoon of chia seeds or ground flax into yogurt or oats.
2. Add half a can of rinsed beans or lentils to soups, salads or sauces.
3. Pick raspberries or blackberries, some of the highest-fiber fruits.
4. Increase fiber slowly over a week and drink more water, so your stomach can adjust.

Pro move: Going too fast with fiber can cause bloating. Add one new fiber food every few days.

#009

Hunger

Social

Eating out

The Flavor Fence

Buffets make you overeat on purpose. Steal their trick and flip it.

THE CALL-OUT

Five dips, three cheeses and two desserts isn't 'a light spread'. It's a buffet in disguise.

Keep main meals simple, with a few flavors. Too many different foods on the table makes you keep eating long after you are full. Save variety for your veggies, where more is actually good.

WHY IT WORKS

This is called 'sensory-specific satiety,' studied by Barbara Rolls and others. You get tired of a flavor as you eat it, which helps you stop. But a new flavor 'resets' your appetite. That is why you always have room for dessert. Fewer flavors per meal helps your natural stop signal work.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Build meals with 1 protein, 1 or 2 veggies and 1 carb, instead of lots of little dishes.
2. At parties and buffets, pick 3 foods you love most, instead of a bite of everything.
3. Use variety on purpose with veggies: mix 3 or 4 colors in a salad to help you eat more of them.

Pro move: Snack boards with 8 kinds of crackers and cheese are appetite resets in disguise. Pick two.

The Real Food Default

Ultra-processed food made people eat around 500 more calories a day. Without noticing.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

If it comes in a crinkly bag with a cartoon mascot, it's not keeping you full. Sorry.

Make most of your meals from foods that still look like where they came from: meat, fish, eggs, beans, veggies, fruit, potatoes, rice, oats. You don't need to be perfect. Just shift the balance.

WHY IT WORKS

In a 2019 study at the US National Institutes of Health, Kevin Hall had people live in a lab and eat either an ultra-processed diet or a minimally processed one. They could eat as much as they wanted. On the ultra-processed diet, they ate about 500 more calories a day and gained weight. On the less processed diet, they ate less and lost weight, without trying.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Look at your 3 most common meals. Find the most processed part of each.
2. Swap just that part: a packaged snack bar becomes fruit plus nuts, flavored instant oats become plain oats with berries.
3. Aim for 'most meals real food,' not 'every bite perfect.'

Pro move: Quick rule: if it has a long ingredient list full of words you can't picture, it is probably ultra-processed.

MYTH VS. TRUTH

~~*Feeling hungry means your diet is working.*~~

Constant hunger usually means your meals are missing protein, fiber or volume. Being hungry all day leads to overeating later, not to lasting results. The goal is to feel satisfied on nourishing food.

TONIGHT'S TRY-THIS

At dinner tonight, eat your veggies first, protein second and carbs last. Put your fork down between bites and make the meal last 20 minutes.

☐ Done

JOURNAL PROMPTS

What did I eat today that kept me full the longest?

Write here...

When did I feel most hungry today, and what had I eaten before it?

Write here...

What number on the hunger scale do I usually stop eating at?

Write here...

*“Hunger is a message,
not an emergency.
Answer it with protein,
not panic.”*

— THE SKINNY LAWS

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The Kitchen Laws

Your kitchen is sabotaging you and you're letting it.

“You don't rise to your willpower. You fall to your kitchen.”

"I just have no willpower." Babe, the cookies are on the counter, the chips are at eye level and you eat standing at the fridge. That's not a willpower problem. That's an interior design problem.

You're not gonna like this, but most of your food choices happen on autopilot. You grab what you see. You eat what's easy. You finish what's in front of you.

Here's the good news: if your choices are mostly automatic, you can change them by changing your space, not by trying harder.

So here's what actually works: set your kitchen up once, so it works for you even on your laziest, most tired day. Then let it do the heavy lifting while you sleep.

In this Law:

The Invisible Shelf

Bowl It, Never Bag It

Serve at the Stove

The Kitchen Closed Ritual

Shop Fed, Shop Listed

The Eye-Level Fridge

The 20-Second Rule

Sunday Decision Day

The Clean Counter Law

The One Seat Rule

The Invisible Shelf

Out of sight really means out of mouth. Make your trigger foods boring.

THE CALL-OUT

'Just one' from the see-through cookie jar on the counter? We both know how that ends.

Move your trigger foods (the ones you can't stop eating once you start) into opaque containers or boxes, and put them on a high shelf or at the back of a cupboard. You are not banning them. You are just making them quiet.

WHY IT WORKS

Seeing food is a strong cue to want food. Bright packaging is designed by experts to grab your attention. When you can't see the chips or cookies, you think about them less, so you eat them less often, without needing to fight yourself.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Pick your top 3 trigger foods.
2. Put them in plain, non-see-through containers or a closed box labeled something boring like 'Misc.'
3. Store them up high, down low or at the very back, anywhere but eye level.
4. Put a healthy snack in the spot they used to be.

Pro move: Use clear containers for healthy food and opaque ones for treats. Let the good stuff be the pretty stuff.

Bowl It, Never Bag It

Eating from the bag has no bottom. A bowl does.

THE CALL-OUT

You didn't eat 'a few chips'. You ate until your fingers hit the bottom of the bag.

Never eat straight from a bag, box or tub. Always put a portion into a bowl or on a plate, close the package, and put it away before you take the first bite.

WHY IT WORKS

A package gives you no stop signal. You keep reaching in until it is gone or you feel sick. A bowl gives your brain a clear end point. Putting the package away also adds a small step if you want more, which gives you time to ask if you are really still hungry.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Get out a small bowl every time you snack, even for a 'quick handful.'
2. Pour your portion, then close the package and put it back in the cupboard.
3. Sit down to eat it. No standing at the counter.
4. If you still want more after, you can have more. Just repeat the whole process.

Pro move: Buy a set of small, pretty snack bowls. Make portioning feel like a treat, not a rule.

#013

Kitchen

Hunger

Social

Serve at the Stove

When the pot is on the table, seconds happen before you even decide.

THE CALL-OUT

Seconds you didn't want, just because the pot was right there winking at you? Classic.

Put food on plates in the kitchen and leave the pots and dishes on the stove. Bring only the plates to the table. Veggies and salad are the one exception: those can go on the table.

WHY IT WORKS

When serving dishes sit in front of you, grabbing more is effortless and often automatic. When you have to get up and walk to the kitchen, you actually decide if you want more. Many times you won't, because the fullness signal has had time to arrive.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Tonight, plate everyone's food at the stove.
2. Put a big bowl of salad or veggies on the table instead of the main dish.
3. If you want seconds, wait 10 minutes first, then get up and serve yourself.

Pro move: Put leftovers into storage containers right after serving, before you sit down. No leftovers, no picking.

The Kitchen Closed Ritual

Restaurants close. Your kitchen can too. Stop running a 24-hour diner.

THE CALL-OUT

Your kitchen doesn't need a night shift. Grazing till midnight is a habit, not hunger.

After dinner, do a short 'closing' routine: clean up, wipe the counter, turn off the kitchen light and say (even just to yourself) 'kitchen closed.' It tells your brain that eating time is over for the day.

WHY IT WORKS

A lot of extra eating happens at night out of habit, boredom or tiredness, not hunger. A ritual creates a clear line between 'eating time' and 'rest time.' Rituals are powerful because they turn a decision into a habit, so you don't have to fight yourself every night.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Right after dinner, put away all food and wipe the counters.
2. Make a cup of herbal tea to take with you out of the kitchen.
3. Turn off the kitchen light and leave the room.
4. If you are truly hungry later, have a planned protein snack like Greek yogurt. Real hunger is allowed.

Pro move: Brush your teeth soon after dinner. Minty mouth plus a closed kitchen is a double lock.

Shop Fed, Shop Listed

A hungry brain in a grocery store is a salesperson's dream customer.

THE CALL-OUT

Shopping starving with no list and coming home with three kinds of cookies? The math ain't mathing.

Only go food shopping after a meal, and always with a list. Stick to the list. Better yet, order groceries online, where you can't smell the bakery or see the checkout candy.

WHY IT WORKS

When you are hungry, high-calorie food looks and smells more rewarding, so it is much easier to grab things you never planned to buy. Stores are also designed to make you buy on impulse. A full stomach and a list protect you from both.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Plan your shopping for right after breakfast, lunch or dinner.
2. Write your list by store section so you can move fast.
3. Shop the outer aisles first, where fresh food usually lives.
4. Try online ordering for one week and notice how much less junk ends up in your cart.

Pro move: If a treat isn't on the list, it doesn't go in the cart. Decide at home, not in the aisle.

The Eye-Level Fridge

Whatever you see first in the fridge is what you eat. Choose wisely.

THE CALL-OUT

The veggies you 'bought to be healthy' are dying in the crisper drawer. Rest in peace.

Wash and cut your fruit and veggies as soon as you get home, put them in clear containers and place them on the middle shelf, right at eye level. Move sauces, leftovers and treats lower or to the back.

WHY IT WORKS

When you're hungry, you grab what is easy and ready. Whole, unwashed produce hidden in the crisper drawer loses to a ready-to-eat snack every time. Make the healthy choice the fastest one and you'll pick it without thinking.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Spend 20 minutes after shopping washing and cutting produce.
2. Store it in clear containers on the middle shelf, front and center.
3. Keep a ready-made dip nearby, like hummus or a Greek yogurt dip.
4. Move treats and high-calorie leftovers to the bottom drawer or the back.

Pro move: Keep a bowl of washed fruit on the counter too. Make it the only food out in the open.

The 20-Second Rule

Add 20 seconds of hassle to a snack and you'll eat it way less often.

THE CALL-OUT

If your trigger snack is easier to reach than a glass of water, that's a setup.

Add small bits of friction to the foods you overeat. Freeze them, wrap them tightly, store them in another room, or buy them only in single servings. Remove friction from healthy foods at the same time.

WHY IT WORKS

Happiness researcher Shawn Achor wrote about this idea: small barriers of about 20 seconds are often enough to stop an automatic habit. You can still have the treat. But you have to want it, not just grab it on autopilot.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Put cookies or chocolate in the freezer, so you have to wait for them to soften.
2. Store the chips in the garage, a high cupboard or a closed box.
3. Buy treats in single-serving packs instead of family-sized bags.
4. Do the opposite for healthy food: pre-cut, washed and in plain sight.

Pro move: Ask someone you live with to keep their snacks in their own drawer, out of your view.

Sunday Decision Day

Tired 7pm you makes terrible food decisions. Let rested you decide in advance.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

'What do I want for dinner?' at 7pm, starving, is how takeout wins every single time.

Once a week, plan your dinners and lunches for the week ahead and write them down. You're not deciding what to eat at 7pm when you're starving. You already decided on Sunday.

WHY IT WORKS

By the end of a long day, your brain is tired of making choices. That is when takeout and snacking win. Deciding ahead of time removes the choice when you're weakest. Research on 'if-then' planning, led by psychologist Peter Gollwitzer, shows that deciding in advance makes people much more likely to follow through.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Every Sunday, write 5 dinners and 3 easy lunches for the week.
2. Build your grocery list straight from that plan.
3. Prep 1 or 2 things ahead: cook a batch of protein, chop veggies, make a big salad.
4. Keep 2 'backup meals' you can make in 10 minutes for chaotic nights.

Pro move: Stick your meal plan on the fridge. Seeing it every day makes it feel like a promise.

The Clean Counter Law

Your counter is a billboard. Stop letting cookies buy ad space.

THE CALL-OUT

A candy dish on the counter isn't decor. It's an all-day invitation you keep accepting.

Clear every food off your kitchen counters except fruit and maybe a jar of nuts. No cereal boxes, no bread, no cookie jar, no candy dish.

WHY IT WORKS

Food you see many times a day becomes food you eat many times a day. Each glance is a small nudge to eat. When the only thing in sight is fruit, the nudges push you in a good direction instead.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Walk into your kitchen now and look at every counter.
2. Put all packaged food into cupboards.
3. Place a bowl of fruit where the snacks used to be.
4. Check the counters again every night as part of your kitchen-closed routine.

Pro move: Do the same in your car, desk and bag. Every place you spend time is a mini kitchen.

The One Seat Rule

If you eat everywhere, you'll want to eat everywhere. Give food one home.

THE CALL-OUT

Eating in bed, on the couch, at your desk... your whole apartment is a snack zone now.

Only eat sitting down at a table, with no phone, TV or laptop. No eating on the couch, in bed, standing in the kitchen or at your desk while working.

WHY IT WORKS

A 2013 review in the American Journal of Clinical Nutrition, led by Eric Robinson, found that eating while distracted led people to eat more, both at that meal and later. When your attention is somewhere else, your brain doesn't fully register the food. Eating in the same spot also stops the couch and bed from becoming cues to snack.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Pick one spot in your home that is your eating spot.
2. Put your phone in another room or face down during meals.
3. If you want a snack while watching TV, put it in a bowl and eat it at the table first, then go back.
4. At work, take your lunch away from your keyboard, even for 10 minutes.

Pro move: Set the table even when eating alone. It turns a meal into an event you actually notice.

MYTH VS. TRUTH

~~People who stay lean just have more self-control around food.~~

Many lean people simply live in homes where tempting food is not always in sight or in reach. They make fewer hard choices because their space makes the easy choice the healthy one. You can build that same space.

TONIGHT'S TRY-THIS

Spend 10 minutes clearing your counters of everything except fruit, and move your top trigger food into an opaque container on a high shelf.

☐ Done

JOURNAL PROMPTS

What foods do I see the most in my kitchen, and are they helping me?

Write here...

Where in my home do I usually eat without thinking?

Write here...

What is one piece of friction I can add to my biggest trigger food?

Write here...

“Stop arguing with your kitchen. Redesign it and let it win for you.”

— THE SKINNY LAWS

The Craving Laws

Your cravings aren't a personality trait. They're a pattern. Break it.

“A craving is a wave, not a command. Let it pass and you win.”

"I have zero self-control around sweets." Babe, you have zero PLAN around sweets. That's different.

You're not gonna like this, but most cravings have nothing to do with hunger. They're about being tired, bored, stressed, or standing in the exact spot where you always eat the thing. Your brain has learned a routine, and it's just pressing play.

The good news? Routines can be hacked. You don't need to ban chocolate forever or white-knuckle your way through every evening. You need to understand how a craving works, and then get sneaky with it.

Here's what actually works: 10 ways to outsmart a craving without feeling deprived. And yes, sometimes the answer is "eat the thing, just properly."

In this Law:

The 10-Minute Wave

The Hunger or Craving Test

The HALT Check

Eat the Real Thing

The Mint Full-Stop

The If-Then Script

The Frozen Dessert Upgrade

The Trigger Map

The Flavor Fatigue Trick

Kill the Forbidden Food

The 10-Minute Wave

That craving that feels like an emergency? It usually fades in about 10 minutes. Time it.

THE CALL-OUT

You didn't 'need' the cookies. You needed 10 minutes and a distraction.

When a craving hits, don't say no. Say "not yet." Set a 10-minute timer and do something else. When the timer goes off, decide again.

WHY IT WORKS

Cravings rise, peak and fall like a wave. Psychologists call riding it out "urge surfing," and it's used in habit and addiction research because it works. Saying "later" feels less like losing than saying "never," so you don't rebel against yourself.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Say out loud: "I can have it in 10 minutes if I still want it."
2. Set a timer on your phone.
3. Leave the kitchen and do something with your hands: text someone, tidy, shower, walk.
4. When the timer rings, check in. If you still want it, have a portion on a plate and enjoy it.

Pro move: Keep a note of how often you still want it after 10 minutes. Most people are shocked how often the answer is no.

The Hunger or Craving Test

If you wouldn't eat a plain chicken breast right now, you're not hungry. You're craving.

THE CALL-OUT

Real hunger isn't that picky. It doesn't 'only want chips'.

Before you eat outside your meals, ask one question: "Would I eat a plain, boring meal right now?" If yes, you're hungry, so eat a real meal. If you only want one specific food, it's a craving.

WHY IT WORKS

Physical hunger builds slowly and is open to lots of foods. Cravings arrive fast, want one exact thing (usually sweet, salty or crunchy) and are often tied to an emotion or a time of day. Knowing which one you're dealing with tells you what to do.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Picture a plain boring meal, like chicken, rice and broccoli.
2. Hungry for it? Eat a proper meal with protein.
3. Only want the specific snack? Go to the 10-Minute Wave hack.
4. Notice the time and your mood, and write it down. Patterns show up fast.

The HALT Check

Half your 'cravings' are actually one of four other problems in disguise.

THE CALL-OUT

You're not craving chocolate. You're tired and you had a horrible meeting.

When you want to snack, run the HALT check: am I Hungry, Angry (or stressed), Lonely or Tired? Then fix the real problem, not just the symptom.

WHY IT WORKS

HALT is an old recovery-group tool because these four states make any habit harder to control. Food is the fastest, easiest fix for all of them, so your brain reaches for it. But food only helps one of the four.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Hungry: eat a real meal or a protein snack.
2. Angry or stressed: 2 minutes of slow breathing, or a quick walk.
3. Lonely: text or call someone.
4. Tired: rest, lie down, or go to bed early. Snacks don't fix tired.

Pro move: Put "HALT?" on a sticky note inside your snack cupboard door.

Eat the Real Thing

Eating 5 'healthy swaps' to avoid one brownie is how you end up eating the brownie too.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

Rice cakes, then yogurt, then almonds, then the brownie anyway. Iconic. Also exhausting.

When you truly want a specific treat, have a normal portion of the real thing. Put it on a plate, sit down, and enjoy every bite. No sad substitutes.

WHY IT WORKS

Substitutes that don't hit the spot leave the craving switched on, so you keep grazing around it and often eat more calories than the treat itself. Eating a portion of the real thing mindfully satisfies it and closes the loop.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Decide on the portion before you start (one brownie, two squares).
2. Put it on a plate. Never eat it from the box.
3. Sit down, no screen, and eat it slowly.
4. Then do something that signals "done": brush teeth, make tea, leave the kitchen.

Pro move: Buy single portions of your favourite treats instead of family packs.

The Mint Full-Stop

There's a reason nothing tastes good after you brush your teeth. Use it on purpose.

THE CALL-OUT

Dinner ended at 7. Your 'little bites' ended at 11. Something's off.

Brush your teeth (or use a strong mint) right after dinner. It works like a full stop at the end of your eating day.

WHY IT WORKS

Mint changes how food tastes for a while, so snacking just isn't as appealing. It also creates a clear routine that tells your brain "eating is over." Rituals like this take away the nightly decision of "should I have something?"

HOW TO DO IT

1. Keep a toothbrush and toothpaste in the kitchen or downstairs bathroom.
2. Brush straight after you clear dinner, not just before bed.
3. If you can't brush, keep strong mints or mint tea ready.
4. Pair it with the Kitchen Closed Ritual for double power.

The If-Then Script

Willpower in the moment is weak. A plan you made earlier is scary strong.

THE CALL-OUT

'I'll just be strong tonight' has failed you 400 times. Time for a script.

Write down your most common craving moment and plan exactly what you'll do: "If it's 9pm and I want chips, then I'll make a cup of tea and eat a bowl of berries."

WHY IT WORKS

Psychologist Peter Gollwitzer's research on "implementation intentions" found that if-then plans make people much more likely to follow through than just setting a goal. The decision is made in advance, so the moment doesn't get a vote.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Name your top 2 craving moments (time + place + feeling).
2. Write one "If ___, then I will ___" line for each.
3. Make the "then" easy and ready to go.
4. Put the script where the craving happens (fridge, phone lock screen).

Pro move: Say your if-then out loud once in the morning. It sounds silly and works better than you think.

The Frozen Dessert Upgrade

Frozen grapes taste like sorbet. Nobody believes it until they try it.

THE CALL-OUT

Eating ice cream from the tub 'until it looks even' is not portion control.

Keep a freezer stash of sweet things that take a long time to eat: frozen grapes, frozen mango, or Greek yogurt bark with berries. Cold food forces you to slow down.

WHY IT WORKS

Frozen fruit is sweet, cold and takes time to eat, so the sweet craving gets answered slowly with fewer calories and more fiber than most desserts. Slower eating also gives your fullness signals time to arrive.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Wash grapes, dry them, and freeze them on a tray, then bag them.
2. Make yogurt bark: spread Greek yogurt on baking paper, add berries, freeze, and snap it.
3. Serve a portion in a small bowl.
4. Keep it at the front of the freezer so it's the first thing you see.

Pro move: Add a sprinkle of cinnamon or a few dark chocolate chips to yogurt bark for 'real dessert' energy.

The Trigger Map

Your cravings run on a schedule. Once you see it, you can't unsee it.

THE CALL-OUT

Every. Single. Day. at 3:30pm you 'randomly' want something sweet. That's not random.

For 5 days, jot down every craving: time, place, mood and what you wanted. Then look for your pattern and change just that moment.

WHY IT WORKS

Habits follow a loop of cue, routine and reward, as described in habit research and made famous by Charles Duhigg's book *The Power of Habit*. You can't change what you can't see. Once you know the cue, you can swap the routine and keep a reward.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Make a note in your phone called "Cravings".
2. Log each one: time, place, mood, food.
3. After 5 days, circle the most common time or place.
4. Change just that cue: move the snack, change the route, plan a new reward.

Pro move: Most people find 1 or 2 moments cause most of their extra eating. Fix those and you're mostly done.

The Flavor Fatigue Trick

The first 3 bites taste amazing. Bite 12 is just habit. Stop when the magic stops.

THE CALL-OUT

You stopped tasting that pizza 4 slices ago. You were just finishing the box.

With treats, pay attention to the first few bites. When the taste stops being exciting, stop. Leave the rest or save it.

WHY IT WORKS

Scientists call it sensory-specific satiety: the pleasure you get from a food drops as you keep eating it. Those first bites give most of the joy. Everything after is mostly autopilot.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Take the first bite slowly and rate it out of 10.
2. Rate it again every few bites.
3. When the score drops by a few points, put it down.
4. Wrap it up for later. You're allowed to have it again tomorrow.

Kill the Forbidden Food

Banning a food makes you want it more. That's not weakness. That's psychology.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

'I'm never eating carbs again' has a shelf life of about 3 days. And then it's bread o'clock.

Stop labelling foods as forbidden. Plan your favourite treats into your week in normal portions, so they lose their power.

WHY IT WORKS

Research on restraint and food cravings suggests that strict banning often makes cravings stronger and leads to a rebound. When a food is allowed, you're less likely to overeat it "before the diet starts again."

HOW TO DO IT

1. Pick 2 or 3 favourite treats.
2. Plan them into your week: e.g. Friday pizza night, Sunday dessert.
3. Enjoy them fully, without guilt.
4. Notice how much calmer you feel around them after a few weeks.

Pro move: Say "I'm having that on Friday" instead of "I can't have that." Your brain relaxes when it knows it's coming.

MYTH VS. TRUTH

~~*Cravings mean your body needs something, like chocolate means you need magnesium.*~~

There's little good evidence for this. Most cravings are learned habits linked to time, place, mood and tiredness. That's actually great news, because learned habits can be changed.

TONIGHT'S TRY-THIS

The next time a craving hits, set a 10-minute timer and leave the kitchen. When it goes off, decide again. Write down what happened.

☐ Done

JOURNAL PROMPTS

When and where do my cravings usually show up?

Write here...

What am I really feeling right before I reach for food?

Write here...

Which food do I 'forbid', and what happens when I finally eat it?

Write here...

*“You don't need more
willpower. You need a
better plan than your
craving has.”*

— THE SKINNY LAWS

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The Movement Laws

'I don't have time for the gym' isn't the excuse you think.

“The gym gets one hour. Your life gets the other fifteen. Win the fifteen.”

"I can't lose weight, I don't have time for the gym." Babe, you sat for 14 hours today and moved from the bed to the desk to the couch. The gym was never the main problem.

You're not gonna like this, but for most people the gym isn't the big lever. The big lever is all the small moving you do the rest of the day. Walking to the car. Pacing on a call. Carrying laundry up the stairs. Scientists call it NEAT, which stands for non-exercise activity thermogenesis. You can call it 'moving without trying'.

NEAT can change a lot from person to person, and from day to day. Lean people often aren't training harder. They just sit less. They fidget, stand, walk and do stuff, without calling it a workout.

So here's what actually works: the lazy-girl version of fitness. No punishing cardio. No 'burning off' last night's pizza. Just small, sneaky ways to move more that fit the life you already have. Stack enough of them and your body quietly does the rest.

In this Law:

[The NEAT Takeover](#)[The 10-Minute Digestion Walk](#)[The Walk-and-Talk Law](#)[The Stair Rule](#)[Step Snacks](#)[The Stand-to-Scroll Rule](#)[The Habit Hitchhike](#)[The Hungry Cardio Trap](#)[The Far-Side Parking Rule](#)[The Walking Pad Office](#)

The NEAT Takeover

Your daily steps can matter more than your workout. Yes, even that spin class.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

One hour at the gym, then 14 hours glued to a chair? That's not a routine, that's a cameo.

Stop thinking of movement as 'the workout' and start thinking of it as your whole day. Find your current daily step average, then raise it slowly. Small, boring movement all day beats one hard session followed by 10 hours on the sofa.

WHY IT WORKS

A well-known 1999 study in the journal *Science*, led by James Levine at the Mayo Clinic, overfed volunteers on purpose. The people who gained the least fat were the ones who naturally moved more in small ways, like fidgeting and standing. Daily movement adds up to far more than most people think, and it does not leave you wrecked or starving.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Check your phone or watch for your average steps over the last 7 days.
2. Add 1,000 steps to that number. That is your new daily target for the next 2 weeks.
3. Once it feels normal, add another 1,000. Keep going until you land around 7,000 to 10,000.

Pro move: Don't jump from 3,000 to 12,000 overnight. Slow raises stick. Big jumps burn you out by Thursday.

The 10-Minute Digestion Walk

A 10-minute walk after eating can flatten your blood sugar spike. Timing is everything.

THE CALL-OUT

Big dinner, straight to the couch, horizontal till bedtime? Your blood sugar would like a word.

Within 30 minutes of finishing your biggest meal, go for an easy 10-minute walk. No sweat, no speed. Just a stroll around the block, the office or even your hallway.

WHY IT WORKS

When you walk, your muscles pull sugar out of your blood to use as fuel. A 2022 review in the journal Sports Medicine found that even a few minutes of light walking after a meal lowered the blood sugar rise compared with sitting. Smaller spikes can mean fewer crashes and fewer 'I need something sweet' moments later.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Pick the meal you eat at home most often, usually dinner.
2. Put your shoes by the door before you sit down to eat.
3. When you finish, walk for 10 minutes before you touch the dishes or the couch.
4. Can't go out? Walk laps of your home or up and down the stairs.

Pro move: Turn it into a ritual with your partner, kid or dog. Nobody skips a walk when the dog is staring at them.

#033

Movement

Quick wins

The Walk-and-Talk Law

Every phone call is a free walk you're currently wasting on the couch.

THE CALL-OUT

An hour-long call with your bestie, spent entirely lying down? That was a free walk, girl.

Make a rule: if you are on the phone and not looking at a screen, you are standing up and walking. Calls with mum, your best friend, customer service, voice notes. All of them are now walking time.

WHY IT WORKS

Most of us spend hours a week on calls while sitting still. A 20-minute call at an easy pace can easily be 2,000 steps or more. You are doing the call anyway, so the steps cost you zero extra time.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Buy or dig out a pair of wireless earbuds so walking feels easy.
2. The moment your phone rings, stand up before you answer.
3. Pace your room, your hallway or walk outside for the whole call.
4. For long work calls with no screen, book them as 'walking meetings' in your calendar.

Pro move: Stuck on hold with your bank? Perfect. That is the best cardio of your life.

The Stair Rule

Two floors or less? The lift is not for you anymore.

THE CALL-OUT

Waiting three minutes for the lift to go up one floor. Not me doing that daily.

Set a simple, non-negotiable rule: if it is two floors or less, you take the stairs. Up or down. No debate, no 'just today'. Rules beat decisions because you don't have to think.

WHY IT WORKS

Climbing stairs uses your biggest muscles, your glutes and thighs, so it takes much more effort than walking on flat ground. It is also great for shaping your legs and bum. And because it is a rule and not a choice, you never waste willpower arguing with yourself.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Decide your number right now: 'two floors or less, always stairs'.
2. At home, stop leaving things at the bottom of the stairs to 'take up later'. Take each thing up now.
3. At work or the mall, walk past the lift and look for the stair sign first.
4. Once two floors is easy, make it three.

Pro move: Going up more than your rule? Take the stairs for the last two floors only. Still counts.

Step Snacks

You snack on food all day. Start snacking on steps instead.

THE CALL-OUT

You'll get up for a snack every hour but not for a two-minute walk? Interesting.

A step snack is a tiny burst of movement, 2 to 5 minutes, sprinkled through your day. Every hour or so, you get up and walk, do a lap, climb a flight of stairs or march on the spot. Small bites, big total.

WHY IT WORKS

Long stretches of sitting keep your body in low-power mode. Short, regular breaks wake your muscles up and keep your daily movement ticking over. Ten step snacks of 3 minutes each is 30 minutes of walking, and you never had to 'find time'.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Set a quiet hourly reminder on your phone or watch from 9am to 5pm.
2. When it buzzes, stand up and move for 2 to 5 minutes. Refill water, walk to the far bathroom, do one flight of stairs.
3. Keep a tally on a sticky note. Aim for 8 step snacks a day.

Pro move: Feeling a craving? Take a step snack first. Often the craving was just boredom.

The Stand-to-Scroll Rule

You're going to scroll anyway. Just stop doing it horizontal.

THE CALL-OUT

Three hours of scrolling, zero steps, then 'I just don't have time to move'. Hmm.

Make one easy swap: when you open TikTok, Instagram or any feed just for fun, you stand up. Lean on the kitchen counter, pace, sway, stretch. Sitting is for work and meals. Scrolling is for standing.

WHY IT WORKS

Standing uses more energy than sitting because your leg and core muscles have to work to keep you upright. It also makes you fidget and shift, which adds more small movement. And a nice bonus: you will probably scroll for less time, because standing gets boring faster than lying on the couch.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Tell yourself the rule out loud once: 'Scrolling is a standing activity'.
2. Every time you catch yourself scrolling while sitting, stand up. No guilt, just stand.
3. Add small moves while you stand: calf raises, side steps or gentle squats during videos.

Pro move: Watching this brand's videos? Do 10 calf raises per video. You're welcome.

The Habit Hitchhike

Glue tiny moves onto things you already do, and they happen on autopilot.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

You stand there staring at the microwave for two minutes anyway. Might as well do calf raises.

Pick habits you never miss, like brushing your teeth, boiling the kettle or waiting for the microwave. Attach one tiny move to each one. The old habit becomes the trigger for the new one.

WHY IT WORKS

New habits fail because you have to remember them. Habits you already have are automatic. When you hook a small move onto an automatic habit, you borrow its power. This is called habit stacking, and it works because the cue is already built into your day.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Write down 3 things you do every single day (for example: kettle, teeth, waiting for the shower to warm up).
2. Match each one with a tiny move: 10 squats while the kettle boils, calf raises while you brush, 20 wall push-ups while the shower warms up.
3. Use this sentence: 'After I ____, I will ____'. Stick it where the habit happens.

Pro move: Keep each move so small it feels silly. Silly and done beats impressive and skipped.

The Hungry Cardio Trap

If intense cardio leaves you ready to eat the whole kitchen, it might be backfiring.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

Brutal cardio, then eating everything in sight because you 'earned it'? That's a trade, not progress.

Notice how you feel after long, hard cardio sessions. If you often want to eat the whole kitchen after, swap some of them for walking and strength training. Keep the moves that leave you feeling good, not starving.

WHY IT WORKS

Hard cardio burns energy, but for some people it also turns hunger way up and makes the sofa feel extra tempting for the rest of the day. That can cancel out the effort.

Walking barely touches your appetite, and strength training helps build muscle, which shapes your body and supports your metabolism.

HOW TO DO IT

1. For the next 2 weeks, rate your hunger from 1 to 10 about an hour after each workout.
2. If hard cardio days are always a 8 or higher, swap 2 of those sessions for brisk walks.
3. Add 2 short strength sessions a week, even 20 minutes of squats, lunges and push-ups at home.
4. After any workout, eat a real meal with protein instead of 'rewarding' yourself with a treat.

Pro move: You don't need to 'earn' food with exercise, ever. Move to feel good, eat to fuel.

The Far-Side Parking Rule

The best parking spot is the worst one. Stop circling like a shark.

THE CALL-OUT

Circling the car park for ten minutes to save a 40-second walk. The irony, babe.

Stop circling for the closest spot. Park at the far end of the car park, get off the bus one stop early, or use the entrance that is furthest from where you need to go. Make distance the default.

WHY IT WORKS

Each far-away choice adds a few hundred steps. Do it at work, the supermarket and school pick-up, and you can add thousands of steps a week without planning a single walk. Bonus: far spots are easier to find, so you stop wasting time and stress hunting for a space.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Today, park in the row furthest from the door. Every trip, every time.
2. If you take the bus or train, get off one stop early on the way home at least 3 times a week.
3. In big stores or malls, walk the long way round to the thing you need.

Pro move: Use a shopping basket instead of a trolley when you only need a few things. Carrying adds work, and you buy less junk.

The Walking Pad Office

Your Netflix habit could be walking you. One piece of kit, free steps.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

A whole season in one night, not one step taken. The couch is winning and it knows it.

A walking pad is a small, flat treadmill that slides under a standing desk or sits in front of your TV. You walk slowly, around 2 to 3 km per hour, while you answer emails, watch a show or scroll. Pair it with chores-as-movement on days you are home.

WHY IT WORKS

You are not trying to sweat. You are replacing sitting time with gentle walking time. One hour at a slow pace can add several thousand steps. It is one of the easiest ways for people with desk jobs to move more without taking time away from anything.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Start with just 20 to 30 minutes a day at a slow speed. Slow is the whole point.
2. Use it during low-focus tasks: emails, calls, Netflix, scrolling. Sit for deep work if you need to.
3. No walking pad yet? Turn chores into movement instead: put on 3 songs and speed-clean, carry laundry one load at a time, hand-wash the car.

Pro move: Wear proper trainers on the pad, not socks or slippers. Your feet and knees will thank you.

MYTH VS. TRUTH

~~*If you don't sweat, it doesn't count.*~~

Sweat is just how your body cools down. It is not a score. Gentle, all-day movement like walking and standing often adds up to more than one intense workout, and it doesn't make you ravenous afterwards.

TONIGHT'S TRY-THIS

After dinner tonight, put your shoes on and take a 10-minute walk before you touch the dishes or the sofa. Put on one podcast episode or call a friend and just go.

☐ Done

JOURNAL PROMPTS

What are 3 things I do every day that I could glue a tiny move onto?

Write here...

When during my day do I sit the longest without getting up?

Write here...

Which kind of movement leaves me feeling energised, and which leaves me starving?

Write here...

“You don't need a harder workout. You need a less glued-to-the-couch life.”

— THE SKINNY LAWS

The Sleep & Stress Laws

You're not hungry. You're exhausted and scrolling at 1am.

“A tired brain shops for snacks. A rested brain doesn't need to.”

"I'll sleep when I'm dead" — okay, but you'll be snacking the whole time until then.

You're not gonna like this, but your 1am TikTok spiral is doing more damage to your waistline than that slice of cake. One bad night messes with the hormones that control hunger, and the next day you're a bottomless pit wondering why nothing fills you up.

Stress does the same thing. A rough day, a tense text, a long to-do list, and suddenly you're standing in front of the pantry like it owes you money.

Here's what actually works: 10 sneaky fixes for sleep and stress. Nothing here needs a 5am wake-up or an hour of meditation. Just small, smart changes that turn your hunger down without you even trying.

In this Law:

The Tired-Hungry Check

The Caffeine Curfew

The Morning Light Hit

Phone Sleeps Outside

The Physiological Sigh

The Cool Room Rule

The Weekend Jet Lag Fix

The 3-Hour Runway

The Stress Menu

The Brain Dump

The Tired-Hungry Check

The day after bad sleep you're a bottomless pit. Here's why, and what to do instead.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

You didn't lack willpower yesterday. You lacked 3 hours of sleep. Different problem.

After a bad night, expect to feel hungrier and plan for it. Eat a bigger protein breakfast, keep easy healthy snacks ready, and don't make big food decisions on no sleep.

WHY IT WORKS

Short sleep raises ghrelin (the hunger hormone) and lowers leptin (the fullness hormone). A study by Dr. Hanlon and colleagues at the University of Chicago found that sleep-restricted people snacked more, especially on high-calorie treats. Knowing this stops you blaming yourself and helps you plan.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Bad night? Tell yourself: "Today I'll be hungrier. That's normal."
2. Add extra protein to breakfast and lunch.
3. Pre-pack two healthy snacks so you don't raid the vending machine.
4. Aim for an earlier night tonight to reset.

The Caffeine Curfew

That 4pm coffee is still in your body at bedtime. And it's why you're starving tomorrow.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

'Coffee doesn't affect me.' Then why are you awake at midnight eating cereal?

Set a caffeine cut-off time: 8 hours before bed, or around 2pm for most people. Switch to decaf or herbal tea after that.

WHY IT WORKS

Caffeine has a half-life of about 5 hours in many adults, so half of your afternoon coffee can still be working at bedtime. Research has shown caffeine taken even 6 hours before bed can cut sleep time. Worse sleep means more hunger the next day.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Work out your bedtime and count back 8 hours. That's your curfew.
2. Put a reminder in your phone.
3. Swap the afternoon coffee for decaf, sparkling water or a walk.
4. Watch hidden caffeine: some teas, energy drinks, pre-workout, and chocolate.

Pro move: Many people who say they 'can't sleep' fix it with this one change within a week.

#043

Sleep

Quick wins

The Morning Light Hit

10 minutes of morning sunlight can make tonight's sleep better. Free. No app needed.

THE CALL-OUT

You spend your morning in a dark room under a blanket, then wonder why your body clock is a mess.

Get outside within an hour of waking for 5 to 15 minutes. Drink your coffee on the balcony, walk to get it, or stand by an open window.

WHY IT WORKS

Morning light helps set your body clock (circadian rhythm), which helps you feel sleepy at the right time at night. Daylight is far brighter than indoor lighting, even on a cloudy day. Better-timed sleep means better appetite control.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Put your shoes by the door the night before.
2. Take your coffee or tea outside.
3. Stay out 5 to 15 minutes (longer if it's cloudy).
4. Don't wear sunglasses for this bit if it's safe and comfy.

Pro move: Combine it with a short walk and you've also hit your first movement of the day.

#044

Sleep

Quick wins

Phone Sleeps Outside

Your phone is the reason you're up at 1am and snacking at 11pm. Evict it.

THE CALL-OUT

'Just 5 more minutes' of scrolling. 2 hours later. A bowl of cereal. Every night.

Charge your phone outside your bedroom. Buy a cheap alarm clock if you need one.

WHY IT WORKS

Late-night scrolling pushes your bedtime later and keeps your brain wired. Screens in bed are also linked to more late-night snacking, because you're awake, bored and a few steps from the kitchen. No phone in bed means less of all of it.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Pick a charging spot outside the bedroom (kitchen or hallway).
2. Buy a basic alarm clock.
3. Set a 'phone goes to bed' alarm 30 minutes before your bedtime.
4. Keep a book or journal by your bed instead.

#045

Stress

Cravings

Quick wins

The Physiological Sigh

A 30-second breathing trick can calm you down faster than a cookie. Science says so.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

Stress-eating chips over the sink is not self-care, babe.

When stress hits, do the physiological sigh: take a deep breath in through your nose, then a second short sip of air on top, then a long, slow breath out through your mouth. Repeat 3 to 5 times.

WHY IT WORKS

A 2023 Stanford study led by David Spiegel and Andrew Huberman found that daily cyclic sighing improved mood and lowered breathing rate better than mindfulness meditation. A long exhale helps switch on your body's calm-down system, so you don't need food to calm down.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Breathe in deeply through your nose.
2. Take one more short breath in on top of it.
3. Breathe out slowly through your mouth, as long as you can.
4. Repeat 3 to 5 times, then decide if you still want the snack.

Pro move: Do it in the car before you walk into the house after work. It stops the 'walk in, open fridge' habit.

The Cool Room Rule

If your bedroom feels cozy-warm, it's probably too warm to sleep well.

THE CALL-OUT

Sleeping in a sauna under 3 blankets and wondering why you wake up at 3am.

Keep your bedroom cool, around 60 to 67°F (16 to 19°C), dark and quiet.

WHY IT WORKS

Your body temperature needs to drop a little for you to fall and stay asleep. Sleep experts often suggest a cool room for better sleep. Better sleep = better control of hunger hormones.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Turn the heating down or crack a window at night.
2. Use lighter bedding or breathable sheets.
3. Block light with blackout curtains or an eye mask.
4. Try a warm shower an hour before bed. Your body cools afterward, which helps sleep.

The Weekend Jet Lag Fix

Sleeping till noon on Sunday is why Monday you eat everything in sight.

THE CALL-OUT

Bed at 3am Saturday, up at noon, then 'why am I so hungry on Mondays?'

Keep your wake-up time within about an hour of your weekday time, even on weekends.

WHY IT WORKS

Big sleep swings between weekdays and weekends create "social jet lag," where your body clock is thrown off like you've flown across time zones. Studies have linked it to worse metabolic health. A steady wake time keeps your appetite and energy steadier too.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Set a weekend alarm no more than 1 hour after your weekday one.
2. If you went to bed late, nap for 20 minutes in the afternoon instead of sleeping in.
3. Get morning light on weekends too.
4. Plan something fun for the morning so getting up feels worth it.

The 3-Hour Runway

Eating a big meal right before bed is like trying to sleep during a party in your stomach.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

Dinner at 7, 'second dinner' at 10:30, and a mystery toast at midnight. Babe.

Try to finish your last proper meal about 2 to 3 hours before bed. If you're truly hungry later, have a small protein snack, like Greek yogurt.

WHY IT WORKS

A big, heavy meal close to bedtime can cause reflux and make sleep worse for some people. A clear end to eating also cuts out mindless night-time snacking, which is often a big source of extra food.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Work out your bedtime and set your 'kitchen closes' time 2 to 3 hours before.
2. Make dinner filling, with protein and veggies.
3. If hungry later, have a small yogurt or a few slices of turkey, not the cereal box.
4. Use a closing ritual: tea, teeth, lights off in the kitchen.

The Stress Menu

Food works for stress because it's fast. So make a list of other fast fixes.

THE CALL-OUT

Your only stress tool is the snack cupboard. That's not a coping skill, that's a pantry.

Write a 'Stress Menu': 5 things that calm you down in under 5 minutes that aren't food. Keep it on your phone and use it before you reach for snacks.

WHY IT WORKS

Stress eating happens because food is a quick, reliable comfort. If you have other quick comforts ready, your brain has options. Planning them ahead matters, because stressed brains don't think creatively.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Write 5 quick non-food calmers: a walk, a shower, a song, a friend, a stretch.
2. Save the list as your phone's lock screen or a note.
3. When stressed, pick one before eating anything.
4. Still want food after? Have a real portion on a plate.

#050

Sleep

Stress

The Brain Dump

Can't sleep because your brain won't shut up? Put it on paper. 5 minutes. Done.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

Lying awake planning tomorrow's to-do list at 1am, then snacking because you're up anyway.

Before bed, spend 5 minutes writing tomorrow's to-do list and anything on your mind.

WHY IT WORKS

A study from Baylor University (Scullin and colleagues, 2018) found that people who wrote a specific to-do list before bed fell asleep faster than people who wrote about things they'd already done. Emptying your head helps it switch off.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Keep a notebook and pen by your bed (not your phone).
2. Write down everything you need to do tomorrow.
3. Add one line: "Tomorrow I'm going to..." and one thing you're looking forward to.
4. Close the notebook. It's handled.

MYTH VS. TRUTH

~~*Sleep has nothing to do with weight. It's all diet and exercise.*~~

Sleep affects the hormones that control hunger and fullness, your cravings and your energy to move. Poor sleep makes every other habit harder, so it's one of the easiest levers to pull.

TONIGHT'S TRY-THIS

Put your phone on charge outside your bedroom tonight. Write tomorrow's to-do list on paper, then go to bed.

☐ Done

JOURNAL PROMPTS

What time do I actually go to sleep, and what keeps me up?

Write here...

What does my body really want when I stress eat?

Write here...

Which 3 things are on my personal Stress Menu?

Write here...

“You can't out-diet a 4-hour sleep. Go to bed, babe.”

— THE SKINNY LAWS

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The Eating-Out & Social Laws

Brunch isn't the problem. Brunch with no game plan is.

“You can go out every weekend. You just can't go out on autopilot.”

"I was so good all week, then the weekend happened." Yeah, it happens every week, bestie. That's not an accident, that's a pattern.

You're not gonna like this, but restaurants, parties and friends' houses are built to make you eat more: big plates, bread baskets, "one more round", and that one friend who says "you only live once" at every single dinner.

The answer isn't staying home with a salad and missing out. That's miserable, and it doesn't last. The answer is going out with a plan so good that nobody even notices you have one.

Here's what actually works: 10 social hacks that let you keep your life AND your progress.

In this Law:

Order First

Menu Stalking

Pick One Treat

The Bread Basket Move

Box Half First

The Drink Strategy

Pre-Party Protein

The Snack Table Distance

The Food Pusher Script

The Fast Food Hack Order

#051

Eating out

Social

Quick wins

Order First

The person who orders last usually orders the worst thing on the menu. Be first.

THE CALL-OUT

You wanted the salmon. Then everyone got burgers, so you got a burger. Classic.

At restaurants, offer to order first. Decide what you want before anyone else talks, and say it.

WHY IT WORKS

People copy each other's food choices, especially in groups. Studies on social eating show we tend to match what others order and how much they eat. Ordering first means your choice is yours, not the table's.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Decide your order before the waiter arrives.
2. When they come, say "I'll go first!" with a smile.
3. Order exactly what you planned.
4. Put the menu down so you're not tempted to rethink it.

#052

Eating out

Quick wins

Menu Stalking

Lean people check the menu online before they go. It's not weird. It's strategy.

THE CALL-OUT

Deciding your order while starving and 2 cocktails in? That's how 'loaded fries for the table' happens.

Look up the menu online before you go out and pick your meal at home, when you're calm and not hungry.

WHY IT WORKS

Decisions made while hungry, distracted and social tend to be more impulsive. Deciding at home means your calm brain makes the choice, not your hungry one.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Search the restaurant menu the day before or on the way.
2. Pick a main with a good protein and some veg.
3. Choose your one treat (see next hack).
4. Screenshot your choice if you want to be extra.

#053

Eating out

Social

Pick One Treat

Drinks OR bread OR dessert. Not all three. That's the whole rule.

THE CALL-OUT

Bread basket, three cocktails, a main AND the 'shared' dessert you ate 80% of.

When you eat out, choose ONE extra: drinks, the bread basket, a starter or dessert. Enjoy that one fully and skip the rest.

WHY IT WORKS

Most of the extra food at restaurants isn't the main meal. It's the add-ons that pile up. One planned treat lets you enjoy yourself without all the extras stacking up.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Before you go, decide on your one treat.
2. Enjoy it properly, no guilt.
3. Politely skip the others ("I'm saving myself for dessert!").
4. Rotate it: dessert this time, cocktails next time.

#054

Eating out

Quick wins

The Bread Basket Move

The bread basket is a trap set before you're even hungry for real food.

THE CALL-OUT

Three pieces of bread with butter before your meal even arrived. And you 'weren't that hungry.'

If bread isn't your one treat, ask the server not to bring it, or take one piece and push the basket to the other end of the table.

WHY IT WORKS

Food that is within easy reach gets eaten more often, just because it's there. Moving it out of reach adds friction, and friction beats willpower.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Ask: "Could we skip the bread today?" if the table agrees.
2. Or take one piece, then slide the basket away from you.
3. Order a side salad or soup to arrive first instead.
4. Sip sparkling water while you wait.

#055

Eating out

Quick wins

Box Half First

Restaurant portions are often huge. Pack half before you start, not after.

THE CALL-OUT

'I'll just eat until I'm full.' Then you look down and the plate is clean. Every time.

When a big meal arrives, ask for a to-go box straight away and put half in it before you take a bite.

WHY IT WORKS

People eat more when they're served more. That's one of the most repeated findings in nutrition research. Once food is off the plate, you're far less likely to keep picking at it.

HOW TO DO IT

1. When ordering, ask for a box to come with the meal.
2. Move half into it before you start eating.
3. Close it and put it to the side.
4. Enjoy tomorrow's lunch. Free meal.

The Drink Strategy

You don't have to stop drinking. You just need a system for your night out.

THE CALL-OUT

Four margaritas and a 2am drive-thru is not a 'little night out'. It's a whole meal plan.

Alternate every alcoholic drink with a glass of water. Pick lower-sugar drinks: spirits with soda water and lime, or dry wine, instead of sugary cocktails.

WHY IT WORKS

Alcohol has calories and lowers your guard around food, which is why the late-night snack happens. Alternating with water slows you down, and choosing less sugary mixers cuts a lot of extra sugar.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Decide your drink limit before you go.
2. Order a water with every drink.
3. Choose vodka soda, gin and slimline tonic, or dry wine.
4. Eat a proper meal with protein before or during drinking.

Pro move: Plan tomorrow's breakfast before you go out, so hungover you doesn't order a double burger.

Pre-Party Protein

Never walk into a party hungry. That's how you end up best friends with the snack table.

THE CALL-OUT

'Saving calories for the party' = arriving starving and eating 40 mini sausage rolls.

Eat a normal meal or a solid protein snack before you go to a party or event, so you arrive satisfied, not starving.

WHY IT WORKS

Arriving very hungry makes grazing on easy party food much more likely. "Saving up" usually backfires, because extreme hunger leads to eating quickly and eating more.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Eat a proper meal 1 to 2 hours before you leave.
2. Or have a protein snack: Greek yogurt, eggs, a protein shake.
3. At the party, take one plate and fill it once.
4. Enjoy the food you really love, and skip the boring stuff.

#058

Social

Quick wins

The Snack Table Distance

Where you stand at a party decides how much you eat. Seriously.

THE CALL-OUT

You spent the entire party 'chatting' next to the chips. We saw you.

At parties, fill a plate once, then move away from the food table. Stand and chat somewhere you can't reach it.

WHY IT WORKS

The easier food is to reach, the more of it people eat, often without noticing. Moving a few steps away adds friction, so you eat when you decide to, not just because it's there.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Take a plate and choose what you really want.
2. Walk to the other side of the room.
3. Hold a drink in your main hand. It keeps you from grabbing.
4. Face away from the food table while you talk.

The Food Pusher Script

"Just have one more!" — here's how to say no without making it weird.

THE CALL-OUT

You ate a second helping because your aunt looked sad. Your aunt is fine, babe.

Have a few friendly, ready-made lines for when people push food on you. Say them with a smile.

WHY IT WORKS

Social pressure is one of the biggest reasons people eat past fullness. Having a script ready means you don't have to think on the spot, and a friendly compliment usually ends the conversation.

HOW TO DO IT

1. "That was SO good. I'm completely full, but can I take some home?"
2. "I'm saving room for dessert!"
3. "I'll grab some in a bit!" (then don't)
4. Compliment the food first. People mostly want to know you liked it.

The Fast Food Hack Order

Sometimes it's the drive-thru. Here's how to order without the regret.

THE CALL-OUT

'Just a burger' became a large meal, a milkshake and nuggets 'for the car'.

When you get fast food, have a go-to 'better order' ready: a grilled chicken option or a single burger, water or diet soda, and a side salad or small fries.

WHY IT WORKS

Choosing on the spot at a drive-thru, when you're hungry and rushed, usually means going bigger. Having one planned order removes the decision, and small switches like the drink and the size of the side add up.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Look up your 2 most-visited fast food places.
2. Pick one 'better order' at each and save it in your notes.
3. Always choose water, diet soda or unsweetened iced tea.
4. Skip 'meal deal' upgrades unless you actually want them.

MYTH VS. TRUTH

~~*You have to give up your social life to get lean.*~~

You don't. People who stay lean long-term still go out. They just have a few simple defaults for restaurants, drinks and parties, so going out doesn't undo their whole week.

THIS WEEK'S TRY-THIS

Before your next meal out, look up the menu, choose your meal and your ONE treat at home. Then order first.

☐ Done

JOURNAL PROMPTS

Which social situations throw me off the most?

Write here...

Who in my life pushes food on me, and what will I say next time?

Write here...

What is my go-to healthy order at my favourite restaurant?

Write here...

*“Go out. Have fun. Just
don't let the bread basket
make your decisions.”*

— THE SKINNY LAWS

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The Grocery & Prep Laws

Your 9pm fridge raid started at the grocery store.

*“Whatever makes it into your cart makes it into your mouth.
Choose at the store.”*

"I just can't stop snacking at night." Girl, you bought three family-size bags of chips 'for guests'. What guests? The math ain't mathing.

You're not gonna like this, but most of your eating choices are made before you ever feel hungry. They're made in the grocery store, with a cart in your hand.

If chips are in the cupboard, you'll eat chips. If ready-to-eat protein is in the fridge, you'll eat protein. Your willpower at 9pm is tired. Your kitchen is not.

So here's what actually works: make your kitchen do the hard work. Smarter lists, faster labels, lazy prep, and flavor tricks that make lean food taste like a treat. Less thinking. Less cooking. Better results.

In this Law: [The Ring + Freezer Route](#) [The Frozen Veg Stash](#) [The 5-Second Protein Test](#)
[The Ready Protein Rule](#) [Components, Not Meals](#) [The Default Dinner Rotation](#)
[The 3-Ingredient Protein Plate](#) [The Portion Pack Sunday](#) [The Big Batch Hour](#)
[The Flavor Cheat Shelf](#)

The Ring + Freezer Route

Shop in a U shape and your cart gets leaner without a single hard decision.

THE CALL-OUT

Zigzagging every middle aisle 'just to look'? That's how the cart fills with stuff you didn't plan.

Walk the outer ring of the store first: produce, meat, fish, eggs, dairy. Then go straight to the frozen aisle for frozen veg, fruit and plain proteins. Only enter the middle aisles with a list, and only for the items on it.

WHY IT WORKS

Stores put fresh, whole foods around the edges and the snacky, easy-to-overeat stuff in the middle. Every aisle you walk down is another chance for an impulse buy. Fewer aisles means fewer temptations, with zero willpower needed.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Start at produce and fill half your cart there.
2. Hit the protein and dairy walls next.
3. Go to the freezer section for bags of veg, fruit and plain shrimp or chicken.
4. Enter a middle aisle only if an item on your list lives there, then walk out.

Pro move: Shop after a meal, never hungry. A full stomach writes a smarter cart.

The Frozen Veg Stash

The cheapest, fastest lean-eating tool in the store is hiding in the freezer.

THE CALL-OUT

'I don't have time to chop veggies' is not an excuse when frozen veg exists. Sorry, babe.

Keep at least 4 bags of frozen vegetables in your freezer at all times. Add a handful to almost every meal: eggs, pasta, rice, soup, even instant noodles. Frozen fruit goes into yogurt and oats.

WHY IT WORKS

Frozen veg is picked and frozen fast, so it keeps its nutrients. It never goes bad, so there is no guilt and no waste. Veg adds lots of volume and fiber for very few calories, so your plate looks big and you feel full.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Buy 4 different bags: broccoli, spinach, stir-fry mix, cauliflower rice.
2. Microwave a cup while your main food cooks.
3. Stir it into whatever you are already eating.
4. Restock when you get down to 2 bags.

Pro move: Roast frozen broccoli straight from the bag at high heat with a little oil and salt. It gets crispy edges, not mushy.

The 5-Second Protein Test

One tiny math trick tells you if a food is working for you or against you.

THE CALL-OUT

'High protein' on the front, 8 grams for 300 calories on the back. The label is lying to you.

Flip any package and find two numbers: calories and protein grams. Ask: does it have about 10 grams of protein for every 100 calories? If yes, it is a lean protein star. If it has less than 5 grams per 100, it is a snack pretending to be healthy.

WHY IT WORKS

Protein keeps you full longer and helps you keep muscle while you lose fat. Many 'protein' bars and snacks are really just sweets with a little protein added. This test cuts through the marketing on the front of the box in seconds.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Look at calories per serving.
2. Look at protein grams per serving.
3. Move the decimal: 200 calories means you want about 20g protein.
4. Keep the winners, put the pretenders back.

Pro move: Greek yogurt, cottage cheese, egg whites, tuna and chicken breast all pass easily. Most granola bars fail badly.

#064

Kitchen

Hunger

Quick wins

The Ready Protein Rule

If protein takes 30 minutes, you'll grab chips. Make it take 30 seconds.

THE CALL-OUT

You didn't 'crave chips'. You just had nothing ready to eat that didn't need a pan.

Always have 3 kinds of protein in the fridge that need zero cooking. Think rotisserie chicken, hard boiled eggs, Greek yogurt, cottage cheese, canned tuna, smoked salmon or pre-cooked shrimp.

WHY IT WORKS

Most people do not overeat because they love junk. They overeat because junk is faster. When protein is just as fast, you pick it more often, and it fills you up so the snacking stops.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Buy a rotisserie chicken and shred it the same day into a container.
2. Boil 6 to 8 eggs at once and keep them peeled.
3. Stock 2 tubs of Greek yogurt or cottage cheese.
4. Put all of it at eye level at the front of the fridge.

Pro move: Pull the chicken while it is still warm. It comes off the bone in 3 minutes instead of 15.

Components, Not Meals

Meal prep fails because you get bored. Prep parts, not plates.

THE CALL-OUT

Five identical boxes of dry chicken and rice by Wednesday? No wonder you ordered pizza.

Instead of 5 identical boxes of chicken and rice, prep separate parts: one protein, one carb, two veg, and one sauce. Each day you mix them in a new way. Bowl on Monday, wrap on Tuesday, salad on Wednesday.

WHY IT WORKS

Eating the same exact meal five days in a row is why most meal prep ends up in the bin by Thursday. Components give you variety with the same hour of work. Variety keeps you on track.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Cook one big protein, like chicken thighs or ground turkey.
2. Cook one carb, like rice, potatoes or pasta.
3. Roast two trays of veg.
4. Make one sauce and store everything in separate boxes.

Pro move: Change just the sauce and spice each day and it feels like a totally new meal.

The Default Dinner Rotation

Decision fatigue is why you order takeout. Remove the decision.

THE CALL-OUT

Scrolling delivery apps for 40 minutes because 'there's nothing to eat'? There's a fridge right there.

Pick 5 easy, lean dinners you already like. Give each one a day of the week. That is your default. You can always change it, but if you are tired, the default wins.

WHY IT WORKS

At the end of a long day your brain is worn out, and the easiest choice wins. When you have no plan, the easiest choice is delivery. A default dinner makes the healthy choice the easy choice.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Write down 5 dinners that take under 20 minutes.
2. Assign each to a weekday, like Taco Tuesday.
3. Build your grocery list from those 5 meals every week.
4. Leave the weekend free and flexible.

Pro move: Stick the list on the fridge. When someone asks what is for dinner, the fridge answers.

The 3-Ingredient Protein Plate

You don't need a recipe. You need a protein, a veg and a flavor bomb.

THE CALL-OUT

Saving 47 recipes on TikTok and cooking zero of them. Not me calling you out.

Build fast meals from just three things: a lean protein, a vegetable, and one strong flavor. Examples: shrimp + frozen stir-fry veg + teriyaki. Eggs + spinach + salsa. Chicken + bagged salad + pesto.

WHY IT WORKS

Complex recipes feel like work, so you skip them. Three items is simple enough to do on your worst day. Protein plus veg gives you fullness and fiber, and the flavor bomb makes it feel like real food, not diet food.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Choose a protein from your fridge.
2. Grab a veg from the freezer or a bagged salad.
3. Add one strong flavor: salsa, pesto, curry paste, hot sauce or everything seasoning.
4. Cook or heat in one pan and eat.

Pro move: Cottage cheese + everything bagel seasoning + sliced cucumber is a 2-minute lunch that tastes like a bagel.

The Portion Pack Sunday

Never eat straight from the big bag again. Future you will say thank you.

THE CALL-OUT

'I'll just have a handful' from the family-size bag. Famous last words.

When you get home from the store, split big bags of snacks into single portions right away. Nuts, crackers, popcorn, cheese, trail mix. Use small bags or boxes.

WHY IT WORKS

When you eat from a big bag, you have no stop sign. You keep going until the bag feels 'done'. A small pack gives you a natural end point, so you enjoy your snack and stop without thinking about it.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Buy a box of small zip bags or mini containers.
2. Read the serving size on the package.
3. Split the whole bag into single servings as soon as you unpack.
4. Put the packs in a basket so grabbing one is easy.

Pro move: Make the portion packs for your favorite treats too. It is not about banning them, it is about giving them a clear finish line.

#069

Kitchen

Maintenance

The Big Batch Hour

One hour of cooking on Sunday saves you from ten bad decisions during the week.

THE CALL-OUT

No plan on Monday means takeout by Tuesday. We've all seen this movie.

Pick one hour a week to cook in bulk. Run the oven, the stove and the rice cooker at the same time. Make enough protein, carbs and veg for 3 to 4 days.

WHY IT WORKS

Cooking every single day is where most people give up. Doing it all at once uses the same heat and the same cleanup for many meals. When food is ready, you eat it instead of ordering.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Put 2 trays of veg and a tray of chicken in the oven together.
2. Cook a big pot of rice or potatoes on the stove.
3. While it cooks, wash and chop fruit for the week.
4. Cool everything and pack into clear boxes.

Pro move: Use clear containers. If you can see the food, you remember to eat it.

The Flavor Cheat Shelf

Lean food isn't boring. You're just missing the right shelf in your fridge.

THE CALL-OUT

Plain chicken, plain rice, then 'healthy food is so boring'? Babe, you forgot the flavor.

Create a shelf of low-calorie flavor boosters: hot sauce, mustard, salsa, pickles, lemon, garlic, vinegar, soy sauce, spice mixes, and plain Greek yogurt for creamy sauces. Use these first, and use creamy, oily dressings as a small extra.

WHY IT WORKS

Most people quit healthy eating because the food tastes flat. Strong flavors like acid, heat and salt make food exciting without adding many calories. Butter, mayo and creamy dressings are not bad, but they add up fast when you pour freely.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Buy 3 new flavor boosters this week, like chili crisp, smoked paprika and a good salsa.
2. Mix Greek yogurt with garlic, lemon and salt for a creamy dip.
3. Squeeze lemon or lime on every plate before adding more salt.
4. Measure oil with a spoon instead of pouring from the bottle.

Pro move: A spray bottle of olive oil gives you crispy roasted veg with a fraction of the oil.

MYTH VS. TRUTH

~~*Fresh vegetables are always healthier than frozen ones.*~~

Frozen vegetables are usually picked ripe and frozen within hours, so they keep their nutrients well. Fresh veg can lose some nutrients while it sits in trucks and fridges. The best vegetable is the one you actually eat, and frozen ones never rot in your drawer.

TONIGHT'S TRY-THIS

Open your fridge and freezer and count your zero-cook proteins and bags of frozen veg. If you have fewer than 3 of each, write them at the top of your next grocery list.

☐ Done

JOURNAL PROMPTS

Which food in my kitchen do I overeat most, and could I portion it or stop buying it for now?

Write here...

What 5 dinners could become my easy default rotation?

Write here...

When do I usually order takeout, and what ready food would stop that?

Write here...

*“Your kitchen is louder
than your willpower.
Stock it like you mean it.”*

— THE SKINNY LAWS

The Drink Laws

Your iced caramel latte is not 'just a coffee'.

“Your stomach counts food. It barely counts drinks. So chew your calories.”

"But I barely eat anything!" Okay, and what are you drinking? Because your iced caramel latte, your 'healthy' green juice and your weekend wine did not sign up to be invisible.

You're not gonna like this, but you can sip a lot of calories and still feel just as hungry as before. Your body doesn't register liquid the same way it registers food you chew.

That means your latte, your juice, your smoothie and your weekend wine might be quietly adding up to a whole extra meal. And you still eat dinner on top of it.

So here's what actually works: no banning your favorite drinks. Just knowing where the hidden calories hide, swapping smart, and building drink rituals that actually help you stay lean.

In this Law:

The Coffee Order Audit

Chew Your Fruit

The Protein Coffee

The Bubbles Ritual

The Tall Thin Glass

The Alcohol Triple Threat

The Mocktail Upgrade

Electrolytes, Not Sports Drinks

The Closing Tea

The Water Anchor

The Coffee Order Audit

Girl, your daily coffee might have more sugar than a donut. Let's fix it, keep the joy.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

You'd never eat a donut every morning. But the caramel latte with extra drizzle? Every single day.

Look up the nutrition info for your usual coffee order today. Then change just one thing: fewer syrup pumps, a smaller size, or milk instead of cream. Keep the ritual, shrink the calories.

WHY IT WORKS

Big café drinks with syrups, whipped cream and sweet creamers can have as many calories as a meal. But because you drink them, they do not fill you up. One small change repeated every day adds up to a big difference over a month.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Find your exact order on the café app or website and check the calories.
2. Cut the syrup pumps in half. Most drinks have 3 to 6 pumps.
3. Swap whipped cream for a sprinkle of cinnamon or cocoa.
4. Size down one step and see if you even notice.

Pro move: Ask for 'half sweet' or '1 pump'. Most people cannot taste the difference after a week.

Chew Your Fruit

The same fruit fills you up way more when you eat it than when you drink it.

THE CALL-OUT

A glass of juice is a pile of oranges without the fiber or the chewing. Your stomach didn't even notice.

Eat whole fruit instead of drinking juice. If you love smoothies, make them thick enough to eat with a spoon, and add protein. Treat juice like a treat, not a health drink.

WHY IT WORKS

A Penn State study by Barbara Rolls found people who ate a whole apple before lunch ate less at the meal than people who had applesauce or apple juice with the same calories. Chewing takes time and whole fruit keeps its fiber, which helps you feel full. Juice removes most of the fiber and goes down in seconds.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Swap your morning juice for a piece of whole fruit.
2. If you make a smoothie, add Greek yogurt or protein powder and use less liquid.
3. Pour it into a bowl and eat it with a spoon, with toppings you can chew.
4. If you drink juice, use a small glass and have it with food.

Pro move: A smoothie bowl you chew feels like a meal. The same smoothie in a straw feels like nothing.

#073

Drinks

Hunger

Quick wins

The Protein Coffee

Turn your morning coffee into something that actually keeps you full until lunch.

THE CALL-OUT

Coffee and nothing else till 2pm, then eating the whole vending machine? That's not a coincidence.

Make your coffee with a scoop of protein powder or a ready-to-drink protein shake instead of creamer. Iced or hot, you get creamy and sweet with a big hit of protein.

WHY IT WORKS

Protein is the most filling thing you can eat. Most people eat very little of it at breakfast. Adding it to a habit you already have (coffee) is the easiest way to get more of it without changing your routine.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Pour a vanilla or caramel protein shake over ice.
2. Add a shot of espresso or cold brew on top.
3. For hot coffee, whisk protein powder with a little cold milk first, then add the hot coffee so it does not clump.
4. Taste and adjust. Add cinnamon if you want more flavor.

Pro move: A small milk frother makes protein powder silky smooth in 10 seconds.

The Bubbles Ritual

Your soda habit is really a fizz habit. Keep the fizz, drop the sugar.

THE CALL-OUT

'I only drink one soda a day.' The math ain't mathing when it's a litre bottle.

Replace sugary soda with sparkling water that you make feel special. Use a nice glass, lots of ice, and real fruit or herbs. Have it at the times you usually reach for soda or a snack.

WHY IT WORKS

A lot of soda drinking is about the feeling: cold, fizzy, a little treat. Sparkling water gives you the same feeling. Making it look pretty tells your brain this is a treat, not a punishment.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Buy a few flavors of unsweetened sparkling water.
2. Fill a nice glass with ice.
3. Add a squeeze of lime, a few berries, cucumber slices or fresh mint.
4. Drink it at your usual soda time or when you want an afternoon snack.

Pro move: Add a splash of tart cherry or cranberry juice for color and flavor with very few calories.

#075

Drinks

Kitchen

Quick wins

The Tall Thin Glass

Change the glass and you change how much you pour, without even trying.

THE CALL-OUT

Your 'one glass of wine' is poured into a glass the size of a fishbowl. We see you.

For any drink with calories, like juice, wine or soda, use a tall thin glass instead of a short wide one. Save the wide glasses for water.

WHY IT WORKS

Our eyes are bad at judging volume. We look at how high the liquid goes, not how wide it is. So a wide glass tricks you into pouring more. A tall glass looks full with less.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Move the short wide glasses to the back of the cupboard.
2. Put tall thin glasses in front.
3. Pour wine into a smaller wine glass, not a huge one.
4. Use wide glasses and jugs for water only.

Pro move: Stop pouring wine when the glass is at its widest point. That is roughly one serving in most glasses.

The Alcohol Triple Threat

Alcohol hits your goals three times: at the bar, in your body, and tomorrow morning.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

'Just drinks' on Friday somehow became cheesy fries at 1am and a hangover brunch. Funny how that works.

Know the three ways alcohol works against you. First, it lowers your guard so you eat more. Second, your body pauses fat burning while it clears the alcohol. Third, bad sleep after drinking makes you hungrier the next day. Plan for all three.

WHY IT WORKS

Your body treats alcohol as a priority to clear out, so it burns that first and puts fat burning on hold. Alcohol also makes it easier to say yes to late-night food. And poor sleep can boost hunger and cravings the next day.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Decide how many drinks you will have before you go out.
2. Eat a proper meal with protein before you drink.
3. Have a glass of water between every drink.
4. Plan a filling protein breakfast for the next morning so you are not hunting for greasy food.

Pro move: Order your first drink as a sparkling water with lime. You arrive calm and you are not drinking on an empty stomach.

The Mocktail Upgrade

You don't need a drink. You need something fancy in your hand.

THE CALL-OUT

Ordering a third cocktail just to have something to hold? A mocktail does that job, babe.

When you want to join in without a lot of alcohol, order or make a real mocktail. Or try a spritz: a small pour of wine or spirit with lots of sparkling water and ice.

WHY IT WORKS

At parties, a lot of drinking is about having something in your hand and feeling part of the fun. A great-looking mocktail or spritz gives you that feeling with much less alcohol and fewer calories.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Ask the bartender for soda water, lime, mint and a splash of bitters in a fancy glass.
2. Make a wine spritz: half wine, half sparkling water, lots of ice.
3. At home, mix sparkling water, crushed berries and fresh herbs in a nice glass.
4. Alternate: one real drink, then one mocktail.

Pro move: Use a cocktail glass at home. Presentation makes a simple drink feel like an event.

Electrolytes, Not Sports Drinks

Unless you're running a marathon, that sports drink is basically soda.

THE CALL-OUT

A 20-minute walk and a full bottle of sports drink after? That's not recovery, that's soda with a gym membership.

For normal workouts and hot days, skip the sugary sports drinks. Use water with a sugar-free electrolyte packet or tablet, or just water and a salty snack after a long sweat.

WHY IT WORKS

Sports drinks are made for long, hard exercise where your body needs quick sugar. For a normal gym session or walk, you do not need that sugar. Low-sugar electrolytes give you the salts without the extra calories.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Keep sugar-free electrolyte packets in your gym bag.
2. Use plain water for workouts under an hour.
3. Add electrolytes on very hot days or after a lot of sweating.
4. Read the label: look for low or zero sugar.

Pro move: Sometimes a 'craving' in the afternoon is really thirst. Try a big glass of water with electrolytes first and see how you feel.

The Closing Tea

Give your kitchen a closing time with a warm cup that tells your brain 'we're done'.

THE CALL-OUT

Grazing from dinner straight till bedtime because the evening feels 'unfinished'? Tea finishes it.

After dinner, make a cup of herbal tea like peppermint, chamomile or rooibos. This is your signal that eating is finished for the day. Sip it slowly on the couch.

WHY IT WORKS

Lots of evening snacking is habit, not hunger. A warm drink gives your hands and mouth something to do. Peppermint also leaves a fresh taste that makes food less tempting. Over time, the tea becomes a routine that says the kitchen is closed.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Buy 2 or 3 herbal teas you enjoy, like peppermint, chamomile or cinnamon.
2. Make one right after dinner or when you clean up.
3. Drink it in your relaxing spot, away from the kitchen.
4. Brush your teeth after for a double 'done' signal.

Pro move: Choose caffeine-free teas at night so your sleep stays deep.

The Water Anchor

Tie a glass of water to things you already do, and you'll never need to 'remember'.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

Three coffees, zero water, then wondering why you're tired and snacky. Hmm, let me think.

Instead of trying to 'drink more water', attach one glass of water to moments that already happen every day: waking up, each meal, and each coffee. Water first, then the thing.

WHY IT WORKS

Vague goals like 'drink more' do not stick. Linking a new habit to an old one makes it automatic. A glass before meals also starts filling your stomach so you feel satisfied a little sooner.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Put a glass by your bed and drink it when you wake up.
2. Drink a glass of water before every meal.
3. Have a glass of water with every coffee.
4. Keep a bottle on your desk in plain sight.

Pro move: Use a bottle with a straw. Most people drink more through a straw without noticing.

MYTH VS. TRUTH

~~*Smoothies and fresh juice are always a healthy choice.*~~

Juice and many smoothies are full of fruit sugar with most of the fiber removed or broken down, and they go down fast. They are fine as a treat, but they do not fill you up like whole fruit. If you want a smoothie, add protein and eat it with a spoon.

TONIGHT'S TRY-THIS

Write down everything you drank today that was not water, plain coffee or plain tea. Pick one and plan a lighter swap for tomorrow.

☐ Done

JOURNAL PROMPTS

Which drink do I have almost every day without thinking about it?

Write here...

When do I drink for comfort or habit, not thirst?

Write here...

What drink ritual could make my evenings feel calm and finished?

Write here...

*“If your coffee needs a
dessert menu, it's not a
coffee anymore. It's a
milkshake.”*

— THE SKINNY LAWS

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The Mindset Laws

'I'll start Monday' has started 52 Mondays a year. Let's fix the brain bit.

“Lean isn't something you do on Mondays. It's who you are on Wednesdays.”

"I just need more motivation." No, babe. You've had motivation. It shows up every January, stays for 9 days, then ghosts you.

You're not gonna like this, but the problem isn't your willpower, your genes or your "slow metabolism". It's the all-or-nothing loop: be perfect, slip once, decide the day is ruined, eat everything, start again Monday. Repeat forever.

The people who stay lean without drama don't have better discipline. They think differently. They don't do "perfect", they don't do "ruined", and they don't punish themselves. Weirdly, that's exactly why they're consistent.

Here's what actually works: 10 mindset shifts that stop the restart cycle for good. Be kind to yourself here. Guilt has never made anyone leaner.

In this Law: [Never Miss Twice](#) [The Identity Sentence](#) [Kill the What-The-Hell Effect](#)
[The 80/20 Plate](#) [No More 'Good' and 'Bad' Food](#) [The 2-Minute Version](#)
[Delete the Finish Line](#) [Talk to Yourself Like a Best Friend](#) [The Comparison Unfollow](#)
[Track Wins, Not Just Weight](#)

Never Miss Twice

One bad meal doesn't ruin anything. Two in a row starts a new habit. Here's the rule.

THE CALL-OUT

Ate one cookie, decided the day was 'ruined', ate the whole box. The math ain't mathing.

Slips are allowed. The only rule is: the very next meal is a normal one. Not a skipped one, not a punishment, not a Monday restart. Just normal.

WHY IT WORKS

Missing once barely affects your progress. What hurts is the spiral that follows. The idea, popularised by James Clear in Atomic Habits, works because it gives you a clear, easy way back instead of a guilt trip.

HOW TO DO IT

1. After a slip, say: "Okay. Next meal is normal."
2. Make that next meal your usual: protein, veg, some carbs.
3. Don't skip it or shrink it to 'make up for' anything.
4. Move on. No diary of shame.

Pro move: Write "Never miss twice" somewhere you'll see it on your worst days.

The Identity Sentence

Stop saying 'I'm trying to lose weight'. Start saying this instead.

THE CALL-OUT

'I'm on a diet' is a sentence with an end date. And you know exactly what happens after it.

Write one sentence starting with "I'm someone who...", like "I'm someone who walks after dinner" or "I'm someone who eats protein at breakfast." Then prove it once today.

WHY IT WORKS

Habits stick better when they're part of who you think you are. Every small action is a 'vote' for that identity. "I'm someone who..." feels like a choice, while "I'm not allowed to..." feels like a rule you'll want to break.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Pick one habit that matters most right now.
2. Write: "I'm someone who ____."
3. Do the smallest possible version of it today.
4. Every time you do it, tell yourself: "That's who I am."

Kill the What-The-Hell Effect

Scientists literally named the 'I already ruined it so I might as well' feeling. Here's the fix.

THE CALL-OUT

'I already had pizza at lunch so dinner doesn't count.' Babe, dinner counts.

When you catch yourself thinking "I've blown it, so who cares", stop and zoom out: one meal is one meal. Then choose the next best option, not the worst one.

WHY IT WORKS

Researchers Janet Polivy and Peter Herman described the "what-the-hell effect": strict dieters who think they've broken their rules often eat more afterwards than people who weren't dieting. Strict rules make small slips feel huge.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Notice the words "ruined", "blown it" or "might as well".
2. Say: "It was one meal. The day isn't over."
3. Choose the next small good thing: water, a walk, a normal dinner.
4. Swap strict rules for flexible ones (next hacks).

The 80/20 Plate

The leanest people you know are not eating perfectly. They're eating 'mostly'.

THE CALL-OUT

Perfect for 4 days, then a 3-day 'treat weekend'. That's 57/43, not 80/20.

Aim for roughly 80% of your food to be simple, filling, whole foods and leave 20% for things you just enjoy. Think in weeks, not single meals.

WHY IT WORKS

Flexible approaches tend to be easier to stick to long-term than strict ones. Research on flexible vs rigid dieting has linked rigid rules with more overeating and more stress around food.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Most meals: protein, veg, a smart carb.
2. Plan your treats into the week: a few per week, enjoyed properly.
3. Don't 'save up' 20% for one wild weekend.
4. Check your week on Sunday, not your day at 3pm.

No More 'Good' and 'Bad' Food

Calling food 'bad' makes you feel bad when you eat it. Then you eat more. Funny how that works.

THE CALL-OUT

'I was so bad today' — you ate a croissant, not a crime.

Drop the words "good", "bad", "clean" and "cheat" when you talk about food. Try "more filling / less filling" or "everyday food / sometimes food" instead.

WHY IT WORKS

Moral labels turn eating into a test you pass or fail, which feeds guilt and the all-or-nothing loop. Neutral words help you make practical choices without the drama.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Notice when you say "bad" or "cheat" about food.
2. Replace it with "sometimes food" or "less filling".
3. Never describe yourself as good or bad based on what you ate.
4. Say it out loud when friends do it too. It's contagious.

The 2-Minute Version

Too tired to work out? Too busy to cook? Do the tiny version. It still counts.

THE CALL-OUT

You skipped the walk because you didn't have 45 minutes. You had 5. You always have 5.

For every habit, have a "2-minute version" for bad days. No time for a workout? Do 10 squats. No time to cook? Rotisserie chicken and a bag of salad.

WHY IT WORKS

Habits are built by repetition, not intensity. Doing a tiny version keeps the habit alive, and on most days, starting is the hardest part. You'll often do more once you've started.

HOW TO DO IT

1. List your 3 key habits.
2. Write a 2-minute version of each.
3. On bad days, do only the 2-minute version and call it a win.
4. Tick it off. The streak matters more than the size.

Delete the Finish Line

The reason diets 'work' and then stop working? They have an end date.

THE CALL-OUT

'Once I hit my goal I can relax.' And that's how the weight comes back. Every time.

Only do things you'd be happy to keep doing for years. Before you start any new habit, ask: "Could I still do this next summer?"

WHY IT WORKS

Most weight regain happens when people go back to their old habits after a diet "ends". If the habit is livable, there's nothing to go back from.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Look at your current plan. Circle anything you'd hate doing for a year.
2. Swap it for something easier you actually like.
3. Keep the hacks that feel almost boring. Boring is sustainable.
4. Stop counting days on a plan. Count habits you keep.

Talk to Yourself Like a Best Friend

Beating yourself up doesn't make you consistent. Science says the opposite.

THE CALL-OUT

You'd never call your best friend 'disgusting' for eating a donut. So why do you say it to yourself?

After a slip, talk to yourself the way you'd talk to a friend: kind, honest and practical. "That happened. What's the plan for tomorrow?"

WHY IT WORKS

Research on self-compassion, including work by Dr. Kristin Neff and a study by Adams and Leary, suggests that being kind to yourself after a slip leads to less overeating afterward than being harsh. Shame makes people want to escape, often with food.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Notice harsh self-talk after eating.
2. Ask: "What would I say to my best friend right now?"
3. Say that to yourself, ideally out loud.
4. Then make one small plan for the next meal.

The Comparison Unfollow

Your feed is quietly making you feel worse about your body. Clean it up.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

Scrolling 'what I eat in a day' videos for 2 hours, then wondering why you feel awful.

Unfollow accounts that make you feel bad about yourself or push extreme diets. Follow people who post practical, kind, realistic content.

WHY IT WORKS

Studies on social media and body image link comparing yourself to edited, filtered images with lower body satisfaction. Feeling bad about your body tends to push people toward unhelpful extremes, not steady habits.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Scroll your feed and notice how each account makes you feel.
2. Mute or unfollow anything that leaves you feeling worse.
3. Watch out for 'what I eat in a day' videos that are very low in food.
4. Follow a few accounts that make you feel motivated and calm.

Track Wins, Not Just Weight

If the scale is your only measure of success, you'll quit in week 3. Track this instead.

THE CALL-OUT

10 great days, the scale went up half a pound, and you quit. Iconic self-sabotage.

Keep a simple list of non-scale wins: sleeping better, clothes fitting, more energy, walking more, less snacking at night.

WHY IT WORKS

Weight goes up and down with water, so it's a noisy daily measure. Seeing other progress keeps you motivated through slow weeks, and motivation is what keeps the habits going.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Start a note called "Wins".
2. Add one win every day, no matter how small.
3. Read it when the scale is annoying you.
4. Tick off the hacks you've tried in this Vault. That's progress too.

MYTH VS. TRUTH

~~*If you just had more willpower, you'd be lean.*~~

Willpower runs out. People who stay lean long-term rely on habits, routines and a kind, flexible mindset. Systems beat willpower every single time.

TODAY'S TRY-THIS

Write your "I'm someone who..." sentence and do the 2-minute version of it before bed tonight.

☐ Done

JOURNAL PROMPTS

What story have I been telling myself about why I can't stay lean?

Write here...

What does my 'all-or-nothing' loop usually look like?

Write here...

How would I talk to my best friend after a messy day of eating?

Write here...

“You don't need a fresh start on Monday. You need a normal next meal.”

— THE SKINNY LAWS

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The De-Bloat Laws

Put down the detox tea, bestie. Bloat has a simpler fix.

“Bloat is not fat. It's weather, and it passes faster when you stop panicking.”

"I'm so bloated, I need a detox." Put down the laxative tea, bestie. That 'fat day' feeling is mostly water, gas and posture, and all three can change in hours, not weeks.

You're not gonna like this, but the panic moves make it worse. Skipping water, crash dieting, weird teas. Fat takes time to lose. Bloat does not. So you have real power over how you feel tomorrow morning, without starving and without drinking less water.

So here's what actually works: the safe, smart moves. No diuretics. No laxatives. No detox anything. Just tricks that work with your body instead of against it.

In this Law:

The Potassium Payback

Decode The Whoosh

The Fiber Staircase

The Air-Swallow Audit

The 10-Minute Digest Stroll

The FODMAP Pause

Ribs Down, Instantly Leaner

The 24-Hour Event Plan

The Cycle Calendar

Sleep Off The Puff

#091

Bloat

Quick wins

Kitchen

The Potassium Payback

Salty dinner? Drinking less water is the wrong move. Eat a banana and drink more.

THE CALL-OUT

Cutting water after a salty meal to 'de-bloat' is like closing the window to air out the room.

After a salty meal, add a potassium-rich food and keep drinking water normally. Good picks are a banana, a baked potato, avocado, spinach, white beans, yogurt or coconut water. Then just let your body do the rest.

WHY IT WORKS

Sodium makes your body hold extra water. Potassium helps your kidneys balance that sodium out, and drinking enough water tells your body it does not need to hoard. Cutting water does the opposite: your body holds on even tighter.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Next morning after a salty meal, eat one potassium food (banana, potato, avocado or spinach).
2. Drink a big glass of water when you wake up and keep sipping all day.
3. Go for a 20-minute walk to get things moving.
4. Ignore the scale for 48 hours. It is water, not fat.

Pro move: Keep a bag of frozen spinach in the freezer. Throw a handful into eggs or a smoothie after takeout night.

Decode The Whoosh

Stuck scale for 10 days, then suddenly down overnight? That's the whoosh. Here's why.

THE CALL-OUT

Quitting your whole plan because the scale didn't move for a week? That's quitting mid-whoosh, babe.

When you lose fat, your body sometimes holds water in its place for a while. So the scale freezes even though you are doing everything right. Then one day, it drops all at once. Your job is to know this so you never quit during the freeze.

WHY IT WORKS

Your body stores carbs as glycogen, and each gram of glycogen is stored with roughly three grams of water. Stress hormones like cortisol can also make you hold water. Add salty meals, hard workouts and your cycle, and the scale can hide real fat loss for days. When stress drops and water releases, you see the whoosh.

HOW TO DO IT

1. When the scale stalls, check your waist with a tape measure instead.
2. Keep your habits the same for 2 more weeks. Do not cut food harder.
3. Add an extra hour of sleep and one relaxing thing (a walk, a bath) to lower stress.
4. Write down the date of every stall so you can see the whoosh pattern over time.

Pro move: A big high-carb meal can actually trigger a whoosh a day or two later, because it can lower stress signals. Don't fear one normal pasta night.

The Fiber Staircase

Going from 10 to 35 grams of fiber overnight? Hello, balloon belly.

THE CALL-OUT

Going from zero veggies to three bean salads a day and blaming 'healthy food' for the bloat. Pace yourself.

Fiber is amazing for staying lean, but your gut needs time to adjust. Add fiber slowly, like climbing stairs, not jumping off a building. Raise it a little each week and drink more water as you go.

WHY IT WORKS

Your gut bacteria eat fiber and make gas while they do it. When you add a lot at once, the bacteria party gets loud and you bloat. Go slowly and your gut adapts, so you get all the fullness benefits without the puff.

HOW TO DO IT

1. This week, add just ONE fiber food per day (like a pear, a half cup of beans, or chia pudding).
2. Next week, add a second one.
3. Drink an extra glass of water for each fiber food you add.
4. If you bloat, stay on the same step for another week before climbing.

Pro move: Cooked veggies are easier on the gut than big raw salads when you are just starting out.

The Air-Swallow Audit

Your 'bloat' might literally be air you swallowed through a straw.

THE CALL-OUT

Gum all day, fizzy drink through a straw, then shocked your belly feels like a balloon? The math ain't mathing.

Some belly bloat is just swallowed air. Straws, chewing gum, fizzy drinks, eating fast and talking while chewing all push air into your stomach. Before an important day, cut these out.

WHY IT WORKS

Every time you sip through a straw or chew gum, you swallow small bits of air. Fizzy drinks add gas directly. That air has to go somewhere, and often it sits in your belly and makes it look rounder. Sugar-free gum can also contain sugar alcohols like sorbitol that cause gas in some people.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Swap sparkling water for still water with lemon or mint for 2 days before an event.
2. Drink straight from the glass, not a straw.
3. Put the gum away and try a mint or brushing your teeth instead.
4. Put your fork down between bites so you swallow less air.

Pro move: Love bubbles? Pour sparkling water into a glass and let it sit 10 minutes. Less fizz, same fun.

#095

Bloat

Movement

Quick wins

The 10-Minute Digest Stroll

A short walk after eating does more for your digestion than any sit-up ever will.

THE CALL-OUT

Big meal, instant nap on the couch, then complaining about feeling heavy all evening. Hmm.

Walk for 10 to 15 minutes after your biggest meal. Slow and easy is fine. You do not need to sweat. Just move.

WHY IT WORKS

Gentle movement helps food and gas move through your gut, so you feel less stuffed and puffy. Research on post-meal walking also shows it can lower the blood sugar spike after eating. That means fewer energy crashes and fewer cravings later.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Set a phone alarm for 5 minutes after dinner that says WALK.
2. Walk around the block, the parking lot, or even your home.
3. Take a family member or call a friend to make it fun.
4. Do it for 7 days and notice how you feel at bedtime.

Pro move: No time? Even 2 to 5 minutes of walking or cleaning the kitchen after eating helps.

The FODMAP Pause

Big event tomorrow? Beans, onion and garlic tonight might be why you feel so gassy.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

Triple bean chilli with extra onion the night before the big day? Bold choice, bestie.

FODMAPs are certain carbs found in foods like beans, lentils, onion, garlic, wheat, apples and some dairy. They are healthy, but they can cause a lot of gas in some people. The day before a big event, pick lower-gas options instead.

WHY IT WORKS

Some carbs are not fully absorbed in your small intestine. They move to your large intestine, where bacteria ferment them and make gas. Researchers at Monash University in Australia created the low-FODMAP approach for people with sensitive guts. You don't need the full diet, just a smart swap before big days.

HOW TO DO IT

1. The day before an event, skip beans, lentils, onion, garlic and big apples.
2. Eat simple meals: rice or potatoes, eggs, chicken or fish, carrots, zucchini, spinach, berries.
3. Use chives or the green part of spring onions for flavor instead of onion and garlic.
4. Go back to your normal healthy foods the day after.

Pro move: This is a short-term event trick, not a forever diet. If you get strong bloating often, talk to a doctor or dietitian.

Ribs Down, Instantly Leaner

Change one thing about how you stand and feel taller and more upright in 3 seconds.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

Ribs flared, back arched, belly pushed forward, then blaming your abs? It's your posture, babe.

Many people stand with their ribs flared out and their lower back arched. This pushes the belly forward. Pull your ribs down, stack them over your hips, and roll your shoulders back. You will look taller and flatter right away.

WHY IT WORKS

When your ribs flare up, your belly muscles stretch and your stomach pops forward. Bringing the ribs down lets your deep core muscles do their job, which pulls your midsection in. Rolling the shoulders back opens your chest and makes your whole shape look longer.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand sideways to a mirror. Breathe out fully like you are fogging a window.
2. Feel your ribs drop down toward your hips. Keep them there as you breathe in through your nose.
3. Roll your shoulders up, back, and down. Think 'long neck'.
4. Practice this every time you wash your hands so it becomes automatic.

Pro move: In photos, stand at a slight angle, put your weight on your back leg and do the ribs-down breath right before the click.

The 24-Hour Event Plan

Crash dieting before an event backfires every time. Do this instead.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

Skipping meals before the big night so you can overeat at it? That's not a plan, that's chaos.

Starving the day before a big event makes you tired, cranky and often more bloated, because you overeat later. Instead, follow a calm, simple plan: normal meals, lower salt, lower gas, lots of water, sleep, and a walk.

WHY IT WORKS

Skipping food raises stress hormones, which can make you hold water. Then when you finally eat, you often eat fast and a lot, which means more air and more bloat. Steady meals, less salt, and good sleep let your body release extra water naturally.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Day before: eat 3 normal meals with protein and easy-to-digest carbs like rice or potatoes. Keep salt and ultra-processed snacks low.
2. Drink water all day and add one potassium food.
3. Skip alcohol, fizzy drinks and gum. Take a 20-minute walk. Be in bed early.
4. Event day: eat a normal breakfast, avoid new foods, and do the ribs-down posture.

Pro move: Plan your outfit the day before. Soft, stretchy fabric in a darker color is the easiest win of all.

The Cycle Calendar

Up 3 pounds the week before your period? That's water, not fat. Stop punishing yourself.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

Panicking over period water weight every single month like it's never happened before? Track it, girl.

Many women hold extra water in the days before their period. Track your cycle and your weight together so you know what is normal for you. Then you can ignore the fake gain and keep going.

WHY IT WORKS

Hormone changes during your cycle can make your body hold more water and salt, and can slow digestion. This is normal and it usually goes away a few days after your period starts. It has nothing to do with fat gain.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Use a period app or a calendar and mark the first day of each period.
2. Write your weight next to it for 2 to 3 months to find your pattern.
3. In your 'puffy week', eat less salty takeout, add potassium foods and keep walking.
4. Do not change your diet because of the number that week. Compare to the same week last month instead.

Pro move: If your bloating is painful or very strong, see a doctor. You deserve to feel good all month.

Sleep Off The Puff

One bad night can leave you puffy. Sleep is your cheapest de-bloater.

THE CALL-OUT

Doom scrolling till 2am then buying a 'de-puffing' serum? Sleep is free, babe.

Short sleep can make you look and feel puffy the next day. Aim for 7 to 9 hours. Also, finish your last big meal 2 to 3 hours before bed so your stomach is not working all night.

WHY IT WORKS

Poor sleep raises stress hormones, which can increase water retention. It also makes you hungrier for salty and sugary food the next day, which adds even more bloat. Eating a huge meal right before bed can also cause reflux and a heavy, puffy feeling in the morning.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Set a 'kitchen closed' time 2 to 3 hours before bed.
2. Put your phone on the other side of the room 30 minutes before sleep.
3. Sleep with your head slightly raised if your face is puffy in the morning.
4. Drink a glass of water when you wake up, before coffee.

Pro move: Puffy face in the morning? A cold splash of water and 5 minutes of walking help it go down faster.

MYTH VS. TRUTH

~~*Detox teas and water pills flush out fat and bloat.*~~

They mostly make you lose water and can make you dehydrated, and some have laxative effects that are harmful. The weight comes right back when you drink and eat again. Real de-bloating comes from potassium, water, sleep, less swallowed air and walking.

TONIGHT'S TRY-THIS

After dinner tonight, take a 10-minute walk, drink a big glass of water, and put your phone away 30 minutes before bed. Check your belly in the mirror tomorrow morning.

☐ Done

JOURNAL PROMPTS

What foods or drinks made me feel most bloated this week?

Write here...

Do my 'fat days' line up with salty meals, bad sleep, or my cycle?

Write here...

How would I treat my body differently if I knew most bloat passes in a day or two?

Write here...

“Bloat is weather, not a verdict. Drink water, go for a walk, let it pass.”

— THE SKINNY LAWS

The Shape Laws

Smaller isn't the goal. Firm, strong and snatched is.

“The scale shows your weight. Your muscles decide your shape.”

"I don't want to lift, I'll get bulky." Babe. People train for YEARS to get bulky. Two sessions a week with dumbbells is not going to do it by accident.

You're not gonna like this, but if all you do is eat less and do cardio, you can lose muscle along with fat. That's how people end up smaller but softer, and frustrated that they don't "look toned". Toned is just muscle with less fat on top.

Here's the plot twist: protein plus a little strength training changes your shape more than any 30-day ab challenge ever will. And you don't need a gym membership or 6 days a week.

Here's what actually works: 10 beginner-friendly laws for a firm, strong body that looks good in jeans and feels good climbing stairs.

In this Law:

The Skinny-Fat Escape

The Two-Session Start

Progressive Overload, Simply

The Palm Rule for Protein

Trust the Tape, Not the Scale

Creatine: The Boring Supplement That Works

The Posture Builders

Lift + Walk = The Combo

Rest Days Are Growth Days

The Toned Arm Truth

The Skinny-Fat Escape

Lost weight but still don't look 'toned'? You didn't lose enough fat. You lost muscle.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

Eating like a bird and doing 2 hours of cardio, then wondering why you look 'soft'. It's the muscle, babe.

Protect your muscle while you lose fat: eat enough protein, lift something heavy-ish twice a week, and avoid very aggressive diets.

WHY IT WORKS

When you lose weight, some of it can be muscle, especially with low protein, no strength training and big calorie cuts. Research shows that strength training and higher protein help people keep muscle while losing fat, which is what makes you look firmer.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Get protein at every meal (see the next hacks).
2. Start two short strength sessions a week.
3. Lose slowly: a small, steady deficit, not a crash.
4. Measure your waist and take photos, not just weight.

The Two-Session Start

You don't need 6 days in the gym. Two short full-body sessions a week is a great start.

THE CALL-OUT

Planned 5 gym days, went once, quit for 3 months. Let's try 2, bestie.

Do two 20 to 30-minute full-body strength sessions a week. Choose 4 to 5 moves: a squat, a hinge (like a deadlift or hip thrust), a push, a pull and a core move.

WHY IT WORKS

Studies suggest that training each muscle group about twice a week works well for building strength and muscle. For beginners, consistency matters far more than having a fancy plan.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Pick two fixed days, e.g. Monday and Thursday.
2. Do: goblet squat, dumbbell deadlift or hip thrust, push-ups (on knees is fine), dumbbell rows, plank.
3. Do 3 rounds of 8 to 12 reps each.
4. Put it in your calendar like a meeting.

Pro move: Learn good form from a trainer or reliable video before adding weight. Stop if something hurts.

Progressive Overload, Simply

Doing the same workout forever? Your body got bored months ago.



THE CALL-OUT

Same pink 2lb dumbbells since 2019. Babe, they're ornaments now.

Make your workouts slightly harder over time: one more rep, a little more weight, or one more set. Small steps, every week or two.

WHY IT WORKS

Muscles grow and get stronger when they're challenged a bit more than they're used to. This is called progressive overload, and it's the core principle of strength training.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Write down your weights and reps each session.
2. When you can do 12 good reps, increase the weight a little.
3. If you can't go heavier, add a rep or a set.
4. Keep your form clean. Never add weight at the cost of form.

The Palm Rule for Protein

No tracking app needed. Your hand tells you how much protein to eat.

THE CALL-OUT

Your 'high-protein' lunch was 3 cherry tomatoes and a sprinkle of feta. Come on.

Aim for 1 to 2 palm-sized portions of protein at each meal. As a general guide, many evidence-based sources suggest around 1.6 grams per kg of body weight a day for people who strength train.

WHY IT WORKS

Protein gives your muscles the building blocks to recover and grow, keeps you full, and helps protect muscle when losing fat. A 2018 review by Morton and colleagues found around 1.6 g/kg/day was helpful for muscle gains with training.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Palm of protein at each meal: chicken, fish, eggs, tofu, Greek yogurt.
2. Add a protein snack if you're short: cottage cheese, a shake, edamame.
3. Spread it through the day instead of one huge dinner.
4. Check with a doctor first if you have kidney problems.

Trust the Tape, Not the Scale

The scale might not move while your jeans get looser. That's a win, not a fail.

THE CALL-OUT

Dropped a dress size, scale didn't move, cried in the bathroom. The scale lied, babe.

Track your shape with a tape measure and photos every 2 to 4 weeks, as well as (or instead of) the scale.

WHY IT WORKS

When you're losing fat and building muscle at the same time, your weight might change slowly while your shape changes a lot. Waist size is also a useful health marker.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Measure your waist at belly-button height, morning, relaxed.
2. Take front, side and back photos in the same light and outfit.
3. Repeat every 2 to 4 weeks, not daily.
4. Keep one pair of jeans as your 'test jeans'.

Creatine: The Boring Supplement That Works

It's one of the most-researched supplements in the world, and it isn't just for gym bros.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

Spent \$60 on a 'fat burner' tea but scared of the most studied supplement ever. Interesting.

Creatine monohydrate (usually 3 to 5 grams a day) is a well-researched supplement that can help with strength training performance. It's optional, not magic.

WHY IT WORKS

Research, including position papers from the International Society of Sports Nutrition, shows creatine can improve strength and training performance and is generally safe for healthy adults. It may add a little water weight in your muscles, which is not fat.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Only consider it if you're doing strength training.
2. Choose plain creatine monohydrate from a tested brand.
3. Take 3 to 5 grams daily with water, any time of day.
4. Ask your doctor first if you have any health conditions, are pregnant or take medication.

Pro move: If the scale goes up a pound or two when you start creatine, that's water in the muscle. Your waist tape will prove it.

The Posture Builders

Train your back and glutes and you'll stand taller without even trying.

THE CALL-OUT

'Tech neck' from 9 hours of scrolling and zero back exercises. Your shoulders are begging.

Add back and glute exercises to every session: rows, band pull-aparts, hip thrusts and glute bridges.

WHY IT WORKS

Many people train the 'mirror muscles' and forget their back and glutes. Stronger back and glute muscles help you hold a more upright posture, which changes how your shape looks and feels.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Add 3 sets of rows (dumbbell or band) to each session.
2. Add 3 sets of hip thrusts or glute bridges.
3. Do 20 band pull-aparts on work breaks.
4. Check your posture every time you sit down: ribs down, shoulders back.

Lift + Walk = The Combo

The most underrated body-changing combo? Strength training plus lots of walking.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

Hardcore HIIT 6 days a week, then you're starving and exhausted. Walk, babe. Walk.

Do your two strength sessions, then get lots of easy walking on the other days. Save intense cardio for when you enjoy it.

WHY IT WORKS

Strength training builds and keeps muscle. Walking adds daily movement without spiking your hunger or wiping you out. It's easy to recover from and easy to do every day.

HOW TO DO IT

1. 2 strength sessions a week.
2. Walk every day, including 10 minutes after meals.
3. Add one fun cardio class a week if you like it.
4. Take it easy on rest days, but still walk.

Rest Days Are Growth Days

Your muscles don't grow in the gym. They grow while you rest.

THE CALL-OUT

Training 7 days a week on 5 hours of sleep and wondering why nothing changes.

Take at least one day off between strength sessions for the same muscles, and aim for 7+ hours of sleep.

WHY IT WORKS

Training creates the signal. Recovery, sleep and food are when your body actually rebuilds. Too little rest can hurt performance and results.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Never train the same muscles hard two days in a row.
2. On rest days, walk and stretch.
3. Prioritise sleep: see the Sleep & Stress Laws.
4. If you're always sore and tired, do less, not more.

The Toned Arm Truth

No, 100 tricep dips won't burn the fat off your arms. Here's what does.

THE CALL-OUT

500 crunches for a flat stomach. Your abs are strong now. They're just hiding.

Forget 'spot-reducing'. To look more toned in one area, lose some overall body fat and build muscle everywhere, including that area.

WHY IT WORKS

Studies show that exercising one body part doesn't burn more fat from that specific spot. Fat loss happens across the whole body. But building the muscle underneath helps the area look firmer as fat comes down.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Do full-body strength sessions, not just 'problem areas'.
2. Include a few moves for areas you want to shape (arms, glutes).
3. Follow your protein and hunger laws for steady fat loss.
4. Be patient: it takes months, not weeks.

MYTH VS. TRUTH

~~*Lifting weights will make women bulky.*~~

Building big muscles takes years of heavy, focused training and eating a lot. Two sessions a week with moderate weights will make you look firmer and stronger, not bulky.

THIS WEEK'S TRY-THIS

Pick two days this week and put a 20-minute strength session in your calendar. Do 3 rounds of squats, push-ups, rows, glute bridges and a plank.

☐ Done

JOURNAL PROMPTS

What would 'strong' look like for me, not just 'small'?

Write here...

What has stopped me from strength training before?

Write here...

Which non-scale changes do I want to notice first?

Write here...

*“Stop shrinking yourself.
Build something instead.”*

— THE SKINNY LAWS

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The Stay-Skinny-Forever Laws

Losing it is the easy part. Keeping it is the flex.

“Maintenance isn't the end of the plan. It IS the plan.”

"I lost it before, I'll just lose it again." Bestie, that's not a strategy, that's a subscription.

You're not gonna like this, but most people who lose weight regain a big chunk of it. Not because they're weak, but because they treat the finish line like a finish line. Diet ends, old habits come back, weight comes back. Then they blame their metabolism.

The people who stay lean for years do a few boring things really well: they keep an eye on the trend, they have a plan for when things creep up, and they keep a handful of habits forever. No drama, no panic, no restarts.

Here's what actually works: 10 laws for staying lean for life, without living on a diet.

In this Law: [Find Your Maintenance Slowly](#) [The Weekly Average Rule](#) [The Alarm Zone](#)
[Your 3 Forever Habits](#) [The Weekend Pattern Fix](#) [The Holiday Game Plan](#)
[The Planned Diet Break](#) [The Maintenance Plate](#) [Too Strict? Read This](#)
[Know When to Get a Pro](#)

Find Your Maintenance Slowly

The day you hit your goal is the most dangerous day. Here's how to land the plane.

THE CALL-OUT

Hit your goal weight, celebrated with a 3-week food festival. Now you're back where you started.

When you reach your goal, add food back slowly over a few weeks: a little extra at one meal, then watch your weekly average for 2 weeks before adding more.

WHY IT WORKS

Jumping straight back to your old eating is the fastest route to regain. Adding food back gradually lets you find how much you can eat while keeping your weight steady. Your body and your hunger adjust more smoothly too.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Add one extra portion of something (e.g. a slice of toast or some fruit) per day.
2. Keep all your protein and veggie habits.
3. Watch your weekly average for 2 weeks.
4. Stable? Add a little more. Creeping up? Go back one step.

The Weekly Average Rule

Up 3 lbs overnight? Relax. It's water. Here's the only number that matters.

THE CALL-OUT

Weighed yourself after a salty dinner, saw +3 lbs, and ate a whole pizza 'because what's the point'.

Weigh yourself most mornings, same conditions, then look only at the 7-day average. Compare this week's average with last week's.

WHY IT WORKS

Daily weight swings with water, salt, carbs, hormones and digestion. The average smooths out the noise and shows the real trend. Some research suggests regular self-weighing helps people maintain weight loss.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Weigh first thing in the morning, after the bathroom, before eating.
2. Log it (the Vault's Weekly Average Tracker does the math).
3. Only react to the weekly average, never one day.
4. If weighing stresses you out, measure your waist monthly instead.

The Alarm Zone

Lean people don't 'let themselves go'. They have an alarm. Set yours.

THE CALL-OUT

'Just a couple of pounds' turned into 15 because you stopped looking for 6 months.

Choose an 'alarm zone' about 3 to 5 lbs (1.5 to 2 kg) above your maintenance weekly average. If your average enters it, switch on your action plan for 2 to 4 weeks.

WHY IT WORKS

Small gains are much easier to reverse than big ones. A clear number means you act early, calmly, before a few pounds turn into a whole new starting point.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Write down your maintenance average and your alarm number.
2. Write your 3-step action plan now (e.g. protein at every meal, kitchen closed at 8pm, daily walk).
3. If the alarm goes off, follow it for 2 to 4 weeks.
4. Back in range? Go back to normal. No drama.

Your 3 Forever Habits

You don't need 120 hacks forever. You need 3 you never drop.

THE CALL-OUT

Did 30 hacks for a month, then zero. Let's keep 3 forever instead.

Pick 3 habits from this Vault that you'll keep for life, no matter what. These are your anchors.

WHY IT WORKS

Research on people who keep weight off long term, like the US National Weight Control Registry, shows they tend to keep a small set of consistent habits, such as regular breakfast, regular activity and self-monitoring. A few solid anchors beat lots of shaky rules.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Look at your ticked and favourite hacks in the Vault.
2. Choose 3 that feel easy and make the biggest difference.
3. Write them on a card or your lock screen.
4. On chaotic weeks, do just these 3.

Pro move: Popular anchors: The Protein Anchor, the 10-Minute Walk, and the Kitchen Closed Ritual.

The Weekend Pattern Fix

If Monday-to-Friday you is lean and weekend you is chaos, this is your hack.

THE CALL-OUT

Perfect all week, then Friday to Sunday undoes it all. Every week. For 3 years.

Keep weekends fun but give them 2 rules: keep your protein breakfast and keep your daily walk. Everything else can be flexible.

WHY IT WORKS

Studies tracking people's weight across the week show many people gain a little on weekends and lose it during the week. When weekends get too big, the week can't balance it out. Two small anchors keep weekends in check without killing the fun.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Saturday and Sunday: protein breakfast, no matter what.
2. Walk every weekend day, even 20 minutes.
3. Use the Pick One Treat rule when out.
4. Plan Sunday dinner as a normal, easy meal.

The Holiday Game Plan

Vacation doesn't have to mean coming home 8 lbs heavier. Here's the easy version.

THE CALL-OUT

'Calories don't count on vacation.' Your jeans the week after disagreed.

On holiday, focus on maintenance, not loss. Keep protein at breakfast, walk a lot, choose your one treat per meal, and enjoy it.

WHY IT WORKS

Trying to diet on holiday usually fails and makes you miserable. Trying to maintain is realistic, and the walking most people do on holiday helps a lot.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Book or pick places where you'll walk a lot.
2. Protein-rich breakfast every day (the buffet has eggs!).
3. One treat per meal: drinks, bread or dessert.
4. Back home: go straight back to your 3 forever habits on day one.

Pro move: Expect the scale to be up a bit after flying and restaurant salt. Give it a week before judging.

The Planned Diet Break

Been dieting for months and feel exhausted? A planned break might help you keep going.

THE CALL-OUT

Dieting non-stop for 8 months and wondering why you're cranky, hungry and stuck.

If you're losing weight for a long time, take a planned 1 to 2-week break at maintenance level every couple of months.

WHY IT WORKS

Long, non-stop dieting can increase hunger and fatigue. Some studies, such as the MATADOR study (Byrne and colleagues, 2018), found that planned breaks helped people stick with their plan. A break also lets you practise maintenance.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Every 8 to 12 weeks of fat loss, plan a 1 to 2-week break.
2. Eat at your estimated maintenance level, still with good habits.
3. Expect a small bump on the scale from water. It's normal.
4. Restart fat loss after the break if you still want to.

The Maintenance Plate

Maintenance doesn't need an app. It needs one simple plate you can build anywhere.

THE CALL-OUT

You need a calorie app, a food scale and a spreadsheet just to eat lunch. That's not a life.

Build most meals like this: a palm or two of protein, half the plate veggies, a fist of smart carbs, a thumb of fat, and something tasty on top.

WHY IT WORKS

A simple plate is easy to remember and works at home, at restaurants and on holiday. It naturally keeps protein and fiber high, which keeps you full, without constant tracking.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Start with protein.
2. Fill half the plate with veggies or salad.
3. Add a fist-sized portion of carbs: rice, potatoes, pasta, bread.
4. Add a small amount of fat and your favourite sauce or seasoning.

Too Strict? Read This

If staying lean is taking over your whole life, something is wrong. Here are the signs.

THE CALL-OUT

Skipping friends' dinners because you're scared of the menu is not 'discipline'. It's a warning sign.

Check in with yourself every month. Signs you're being too strict: thinking about food all day, skipping social events because of food, feeling panic or guilt after eating, cutting out whole food groups out of fear, or feeling tired and cold all the time. If you notice these, ease up and get support.

WHY IT WORKS

Being lean should make your life bigger, not smaller. Very strict eating can harm your health and your relationship with food. Eating disorders are serious, and getting help early makes a real difference.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Once a month, read the list above honestly.
2. If 2 or more sound like you, add more food and flexibility back in.
3. Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian.
4. For support: ANAD (anad.org) in the US or Beat (beateatingdisorders.org.uk) in the UK.

Know When to Get a Pro

Doing everything right and nothing is changing? It might not be you. Get checked.

🔥 THE CALL-OUT

Blaming yourself for 2 years when it could've been a thyroid check. Go to the doctor, babe.

If you're truly consistent for 2 to 3 months and nothing changes, or you have unusual symptoms, see a doctor or registered dietitian.

WHY IT WORKS

Some medical conditions (like thyroid issues or PCOS) and some medications can affect weight and hunger. A professional can check for these and give you advice made for your body.

HOW TO DO IT

1. Keep notes of your habits and weekly averages for 8 to 12 weeks.
2. Book a doctor's appointment and bring the notes.
3. Ask about blood tests if you have symptoms like tiredness, hair changes or irregular periods.
4. Ask for a referral to a registered dietitian if you want personal help.

MYTH VS. TRUTH

~~*Once you lose the weight, you're done.*~~

Keeping it off is a skill of its own. The people who succeed keep a few habits, watch the trend, and act early when things creep up. It gets easier and more automatic with time.

THIS WEEK'S TRY-THIS

Choose your 3 forever habits and write them on your phone lock screen. Then set your alarm zone number.

☐ Done

JOURNAL PROMPTS

Which 3 habits will I keep forever, no matter what?

Write here...

What usually happens after I 'finish' a diet?

Write here...

What does a happy, relaxed, lean life look like for me?

Write here...

*“Anyone can lose it.
Keeping it is the real
flex.”*

— THE SKINNY LAWS

BONUS 1

The 30-Day Skinny Laws Challenge

One tiny action per day. Tick it off when it's done. Missed a day? Never miss twice — just do today's.

DAY 1

Take the quiz and pick your first 3 hacks.

☐

DAY 2

Build a protein anchor breakfast.

☐

DAY 3

Eat your veggies and protein first at one meal.

☐

DAY 4

Move one trigger food out of sight.

☐

DAY 5

Take a 10-minute walk after dinner.

☐

DAY 6

Close the kitchen after dinner with a ritual.

☐

DAY 7

Plate your food in the kitchen, not at the table.

☐

DAY 8

Do the 10-minute craving delay once.

☐

DAY 9

Set a caffeine cut-off time and keep it.

☐

DAY 10

Phone out of the bedroom tonight.

☐

DAY 11

Plan tomorrow's meals in 3 minutes.

☐

DAY 12

Do one walking phone call.

☐

DAY 13

Audit your coffee order.

☐

DAY 14

Swap one drink for sparkling water with fruit.

☐

DAY 15

Check-in: which hacks feel easy? Keep those.

☐

DAY 16

Shop from a list, after eating.

☐

DAY 17

Prep one protein and one veg for the week.

☐

DAY 18

Try one 3-ingredient high-protein meal.

☐

DAY 19

Read the menu before you go out.

☐

DAY 20

Do a 2-minute downshift when stressed.

☐

DAY 21

Write your "I'm someone who..." sentence.

☐

DAY 22

Take your first strength session (20 minutes).

☐

DAY 23

Measure your waist and take a progress photo.

☐

DAY 24

Eat one meal with no screen.

☐

DAY 25

Try the hunger scale before every meal today.

☐

DAY 26

Plan your weekend using the social laws.

☐

DAY 27

Do a second strength session.

☐

DAY 28

Make your personal "alarm zone" plan.

☐

DAY 29☐

Pick your 3 forever anchor habits.

DAY 30☐

Look back: write what changed. You did it.

BONUS 2

The Lean Grocery List

Screenshot this or tick items as you shop.

PROTEIN

- ☐ Eggs / liquid egg whites
- ☐ Greek yogurt or skyr (plain)
- ☐ Cottage cheese
- ☐ Rotisserie chicken
- ☐ Chicken breast or thighs
- ☐ Canned tuna or salmon
- ☐ Shrimp (frozen)
- ☐ Lean ground turkey or beef
- ☐ Tofu or tempeh
- ☐ Protein powder you actually like

VOLUME FOODS

- ☐ Bagged salad greens
- ☐ Frozen stir-fry vegetables
- ☐ Frozen cauliflower rice
- ☐ Cucumbers & cherry tomatoes
- ☐ Bell peppers
- ☐ Zucchini
- ☐ Mushrooms
- ☐ Broth-based soups
- ☐ Air-popped popcorn kernels

SMART CARBS

- ☐ Oats
- ☐ Potatoes (fill you up for their calories)
- ☐ Rice (cook, cool, reheat)
- ☐ Wholegrain wraps
- ☐ Beans & lentils
- ☐ Berries (fresh or frozen)
- ☐ Apples & oranges
- ☐ Frozen grapes (dessert hack)

FLAVOR WITHOUT THE CALORIES

- ☐ Hot sauce
- ☐ Salsa
- ☐ Mustard
- ☐ Everything-bagel seasoning
- ☐ Lemon & lime
- ☐ Fresh herbs
- ☐ Rice vinegar / apple cider vinegar
- ☐ Soy sauce or coconut aminos
- ☐ Cinnamon

DRINKS & SNACKS

- ☐ Sparkling water
- ☐ Herbal teas
- ☐ Dark chocolate (85%)
- ☐ Pickles
- ☐ Seaweed snacks
- ☐ Edamame (frozen)
- ☐ Pistachios in shells
- ☐ Beef or turkey jerky

BONUS 3

Restaurant Cheat Sheet

What to order (and what to watch) at 8 kinds of places. No salads-only rule required.

ITALIAN

Order: Grilled fish or chicken with veg; share a pasta as a side, not a main.

Watch out: Bread basket + creamy sauces.

MEXICAN

Order: Fajitas or a burrito bowl: double protein, salsa, lettuce, half rice.

Watch out: Chips before the meal, sour cream, cheese sauce.

SUSHI

Order: Sashimi, edamame, miso soup, one roll.

Watch out: Tempura and 'crunchy' or mayo rolls.

BURGER PLACE

Order: Burger with lettuce wrap or open-faced, side salad or shared fries.

Watch out: Milkshakes and double sauce.

CHINESE / THAI

Order: Steamed or stir-fried protein with veg; ask for sauce on the side.

Watch out: Fried rice, sweet and sour, anything 'crispy'.

BRUNCH

Order: Eggs any style, smoked salmon, side of fruit; share the pancakes.

Watch out: Bottomless mimosas + the pastry basket.

COFFEE SHOP

Order: Latte with milk of choice, no syrup or 1 pump; protein box if hungry.

Watch out: Frappes and 'seasonal' drinks (often dessert in a cup).

PIZZA NIGHT

Order: Thin crust, veg + chicken topping, big side salad first.

Watch out: Stuffed crust and garlic dips.

BONUS 4

Weekly Average Tracker

Daily weight jumps around with water, salt and hormones. Only the weekly average matters. Enter what you have — it does the math and saves on this device.

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun

This week's average:

Last week's average:

BONUS 5

The 12 Laws on one page

01

The Hunger Laws

Willpower is a weak volume knob. Build meals that turn hunger down for you.

02

The Kitchen Laws

You don't rise to your willpower. You fall to your kitchen.

03

The Craving Laws

A craving is a wave, not a command. Let it pass and you win.

04

The Movement Laws

The gym gets one hour. Your life gets the other fifteen. Win the fifteen.

05

The Sleep & Stress Laws

A tired brain shops for snacks. A rested brain doesn't need to.

06

The Eating-Out & Social Laws

You can go out every weekend. You just can't go out on autopilot.

07

The Grocery & Prep Laws

Whatever makes it into your cart makes it into your mouth. Choose at the store.

08

The Drink Laws

Your stomach counts food. It barely counts drinks. So chew your calories.

09

The Mindset Laws

Lean isn't something you do on Mondays. It's who you are on Wednesdays.

10

The De-Bloat Laws

Bloat is not fat. It's weather, and it passes faster when you stop panicking.

11

The Shape Laws

The scale shows your weight. Your muscles decide your shape.

12

The Stay-Skinny-Forever Laws

Maintenance isn't the end of the plan. It IS the plan.

BONUS 6

My Favorites

Tap "★ Favorite" on any hack and it shows up here — your personal cheat sheet.

No favorites yet. Tap ★ Favorite on any hack.

Safety & support

This guide is for healthy adults who want to get leaner in a kind, sustainable way. It is general education, not medical advice. Talk to a doctor or registered dietitian before big changes, especially if you are pregnant, breastfeeding, under 18, take medication, or have a health condition.

Being lean should make your life bigger, not smaller. If food, weight or your body is taking up most of your thoughts, if you feel out of control around food, or if you are cutting out meals or feel you have to "make up" for eating, please reach out for support. In the US you can contact the ANAD helpline (anad.org) or talk to your doctor. In the UK, contact Beat (beateatingdisorders.org.uk). You deserve help, and it works.

You made it to the end. Most people don't, which is exactly why most people are still starting over on Monday.

Here's the secret: the people who stay lean forever aren't stricter than you. They just have better systems. You now have 120 of them. No excuses left, bestie.

Pick your favorites. Make them boring and automatic. Come back when life gets messy. And when someone asks what you're doing differently? Just smile and say nothing.

With love (and a little sass),
The Skinny Laws

@theskinnylaws